

SLIDE # 1-

How do we Attract new membership for the entire Masonic Family?

SEE APPENDIX B – For Further Clarification.

Good morning, Welcome all Brethren, Companions, Sir Knights. My name is William E. McCraw; But seeing that we are all family here, feel free to call me Sonny, William, or Bill if you'd like.

What an amazing day it is to be alive. We live in interesting times. It has never been so fortuitous and lucky than it is to be a Freemason, right here and right now - in this place today. Each of us has the great potential to make a lasting impact in the world. You can be the catalyst for greater good within your neighborhood and community. I say this with the greatest of confidence – Because I have been fortunate enough to bear witness to that claim.

I have seen Freemasonry offer purpose and direction to the life of young men. I have watched the growth and character development of a man who took the journey from Aspirant to an Officer in the Lodge. I have watched strangers become family; and family rally together to lift each other up – “to higher thoughts; to nobler deeds; and to greater achievements.” I have been the recipient of the greatest forms of trust, faith, Brotherly Love, justice, and charity (that charity which is expressed in the Fellow Craft Degree and expounded upon within the explanation of the five points of fellowship); I have experienced this altruistically, within our “Sacred band or society of friends and Brothers.” . Yes, today is a great day to be a Freemason.

SLIDE # 2 -

We've all seen Charts like the following. Here we have a rough scope, or bird's eye view of the entire Masonic Family. The Masonic Family is a vast and wide array of Degrees, Systems, Rites, Orders, Clubs, and Appendant Bodies. There is something for every Mason, Friend of a Mason, or relative to explore and experience. Each experience within Freemasonry teaches a lesson necessary to the improvement and development of the individual.

In essence, Freemasonry is properly a confraternity, or a volunteer association of the faithful dedicated to mutual moral support through compassion and encouragement of discovering the very

best version of self that the individual can achieve. Each section of the wheel chart expresses the multitudes of opportunity that a person can take advantage of.

There exists for young men, opportunities such as what we offer within the DeMolay programs; which includes a Squires program for young men ages 9 to 11. They can then choose to transition from the Squires Manors to the DeMolay Chapters by age 12. By age 17 the DeMolay can transition to The Chivalric Knights of the Holy Order of the Fellow Soldiers of Jacques DeMolay, or what is termed the “Knighthood Program.” This is separate from the Invitational/honors program we understand to be the Chevaliers.

The International Order of the Rainbow for Girls is offered in some jurisdictions to young women ages 11 to 20. Of course, young ladies who are relatives of Masons can choose to join the Job’s Daughters International program starting with the Bees (or Jobbies to Be) Program by age 9, which they can then transition to the Job’s Daughters Bethels by age 10.

For Women who are relatives of Masons, there are bodies such as the Ladies of the Oriental Shrine, the Daughters of the Nile, The Social Order of the Beauceant, and the Appendant Bodies that welcome Master Masons and Women who are relatives of Master Masons alike; such as the Order of the Eastern Star, the Order of the Amaranth, and the White Shrine of Jerusalem.

Men who are Raised to the Sublime Degree of Master Mason and become Members In Good Standing of a Symbolic Lodge, may choose to join one or both of the Rites of Freemasonry: the York Rite and the Scottish Rite.

Within Ancient Craft Masonry (York Rite), as is the case with the Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite of Freemasonry – there exists 4 separate Bodies. Both Rites have mutually beneficial agreements with our respective Grand Lodge(s) to embrace the Blue Lodge (Symbolic Lodge /Craft Lodge) degrees as the first three degrees of the system of that Rite. The York Rite properly considers the Symbolic Lodge the first Body of that Rite. The Chapter of Royal Arch Masons completes the second Body of the York Rite. In Cryptic Masonry, the Council of Cryptic Masons (Royal and Select Masters) - or third Body of the York Rite, will in some Grand Jurisdictions include the Solemn Feast of Belshazzar and the Super Excellent Master Degree as a part of that Body. The Orders of the Commandery of Knights Templar is the Fourth Body of the York Rite System; concluding with the Most Valiant and Magnanimous Holy Order of the Temple. Each Body within the York Rite governs

independent of one another, and yet the several Bodies work amicably and in cooperation with each other.

How the Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite of Freemasonry essentially differs is in its structure and government. With the Craft Degrees being considered a necessary part of the Scottish Rite system, the structure and government of the first body: the Lodge of Perfection - begins with the 4° and ends at the 14°. The Second Body: the Chapter of Rose+Croix naturally begins at the 15° and ends with the 18°. The 19° through the 30° wrap up the Third Body of the Scottish Rite: the Council of Kadosh. The final Body the Consistory of Masters of the Royal Secret is complete when a Master Mason is elevated a 32° Master of the Royal Secret. Each Body in the Scottish Rite is separate and distinct; yet work in concert with one another as a part of a Valley. All the Valleys within a Grand Jurisdiction come under the guidance and governance of the Orient. All the Orients of a Jurisdiction come under the governance and guidance of a Supreme Council.

Ideally, a Master Mason experiences the Rites of Freemasonry well before he joins one of the Social Orders in Freemasonry such as the Tall Cedars of Lebanon, Ancient Egyptian Order of Sciots, Mystic Order of Veiled Prophets of the Enchanted Realm (Grotto), or the Ancient Arabic Order of Nobles of the Mystic Shrine (Shrine).

If a Master Mason, York Rite, or Scottish Rite Mason meets certain requirements, he may be invited to join one of the phenomenal opportunities within the several Invitational Bodies or Orders of Freemasonry; Or he may also choose to seek greater educational opportunities by joining a Research Lodge or Society.

SEE APPENDIX A - For further information.

Of course, if the Master Mason was honorably discharged or is an active service member of one of the Branches within the U.S. Armed Forces he should be afforded the opportunity to join and support the National Sojourners.

As Freemasonry evolves, Special Interest clubs have afforded Masons who share that interest to join together in fellowship. These special interest clubs include Dinner clubs that offer educational and

speaker engagements, Masonic Motorcycle Rider Associations, Fine Tobacco Societies, Gun Clubs, Aviation Clubs, Ham Radio Operator Clubs, Geocaching Societies, National Masonic Family Camping Societies, and so much more.

SLIDE # 3 -

Here in Utah, we have unique opportunities for Master Masons, Companions, and Sir Knights who are in amity with this Grand Jurisdiction to enjoy. For the Master Mason we have the Society of Ash and Stone for Brethren who enjoy fine tobacco; and the Craftsmen Masonic Motorcycle Riders Association – for the Masonic Family who enjoys riding Motorcycles and still wishes to promote the lessons and values of Freemasonry. We also are home to Camp Floyd Historic Lodge No. 205 – which is a Masonic Historical Preservation Society / Club that preserves the first Military and Masonic presence in Utah – previous to the American Civil War or the statehood of Utah. For Companions we have Keystone Mark Master Masons Lodge No. 00 – which is a European concept Mark Master Masons Lodge – this offers the Mark Master Degree as an educational feature to Master Masons, which allows a Master Mason his first impression of the York Rite. To the members who join Keystone Mark Master Masons Lodge No. 00, they can take pride knowing that half of their annual membership fee is donated to the Royal Arch Research Association. For Sir Knights of the Most Valiant and Magnanimous Holy Order of the Temple who hold amity and Fraternal Recognition with the Grand Commandery of the State of Utah, we have the Samuel Paul Honors Commandery No. 00. To the members who join Samuel Paul Honors Commandery No. 00; they can rest easy knowing that the purpose of this Commandry is to assist the Grand Commandery of the State of Utah, in raising awareness and funds for the Knight Templar Eye Foundation, Incorporated (KTEF), confer the Orders of the Commandery, Hold Schools of Instruction; as well as to provide an opportunity for Sir Knights of Utah, and other Grand Jurisdictions to further support the Grand Commandery of the State of Utah, and all Constituent Commanderies within the Grand Jurisdiction of Utah.

SLIDE # 4 -

None of this is possible without one common denominator – the Symbolic Lodge and the initiatic experience. By this, we understand one truth – Freemasonry is:

3 degrees, 2 Rites, 1 Sacred Brotherhood.

SLIDE # 5

"Lodges do two things:

- 1.)- They make new Masons,
- 2.)- and they make new Friends.

If they don't, they won't survive."- Companion John C. Liley Jr., PGM, KYGCH, 33°. Most Excellent High Priest of the Most Excellent Grand Chapter of Royal Arch Masons of Utah

This is the key that unlocks the world of Freemasonry and the entire Masonic Family to the good men we hope will join our family and begin a lifelong journey with us. How do we approach this and gain the desired effect? Today, I aim to shift your perspective and open your hearts to the possible.

SLIDE # 6 -

"Nothing Positive ever came from anything Negative." Cecil H. Connell, KYCH

However grammatically atrocious this statement might sound; the weight of its truth is profound.

SLIDE # 7 -

Leading psychologists, Johns Hopkins University, and the Mayo Clinic - all agree that a positive mental attitude, and an attitude of gratitude create a healthier, happier and more productive environment. Some of the lasting benefits from this environment include:

- Better stress management and coping skills during stressful moments
- Lower risk of depression
- More resistant to the common cold and a stronger immune system
- Decreased risk of heart attacks and heart disease
- Lower blood pressure
- Better problem-solving
- Greater ability to adapt to change
- More creative thinking
- Consistent attitude with fewer mood swings
- Stronger leadership skills
- And an increased resiliency or the ability to overcome difficulty.

SLIDE # 8 -

“Your mental attitude is something you can control outright and you must use self-discipline until you create a Positive Mental Attitude - your mental attitude attracts to you everything that makes you what you are.” – Napoleon Hill

Why should this matter to us? Simple, Child development has revealed that males thrive in structured environments and are more apt to choose positive environments.

The ability to create ‘curb appeal’ begins with how Freemasonry is presented and perceived to the aspirant. If the Lodge presents a youthful, positive, caring, supportive, active, family-friendly environment it will become the welcome mat and home for the types of men seeking to be a part of the same. In the end, men will always choose a positive environment that encourages success. It should be our goal to transform our thoughts, words, and deeds to foster success.

SLIDE # 9 -

Freemasonry instructs us to create this environment as early as the Entered Apprentice Degree – We are entrusted with a Badge of Honor; which we are taught to symbolically and metaphorically wear daily as an “ever-present reminder of a purity of life and rectitude of conduct, a never-ending argument for nobler deeds, higher thoughts, and greater achievements” - The Treasury Of Masonic Thought –by George M. Martin & John W. Callaghan (1924)

If we hope to make new Masons and make new friends, we cannot have curb appeal alone. We must lead the charge by becoming the example that attracts great men to ask for that petition.

SLIDE # 10 -

In the early 2000’s there was a focus on membership as a whole. This came in the form of the Total Membership Committee. I was proud to serve on this committee. There were four main points of focus.

- Attraction – The journey from Aspirant to Petitioner. Our goal should be to pique the interest of aspirants.
- Attention – The journey from the Elect throughout their candidacy, to becoming a voting member. Our goal here should be to help Aspirants transition from Aspirant to Petitioner; and likewise - from Petitioner to Candidate/Member.

- Retention – The ability to keep and inspire the member. Our Goal here is twofold - Membership needs and Officer requirements.*
- Restoration – the ability to encourage their return to full active member. To put it in the simplest terms; we must reasonably close the 'South Gate' - and entice our members to return to our Masonic Family.

Attention and Retention can be easily solved at a Grand Lodge/Lodge level through:

- Meeting the needs of the membership – fulfilling the reasons why they joined and offering them a reason to stay.*
- Certified Coach Programs to standardize the education of the Catechism.
- Certified Mentor Programs to standardize the training of decorum, etiquette, Tradition, Culture, Protocol, and Guidance along the candidate's Masonic Journey.
- * Masonic Educational Opportunities via Masonic University / Online Schools
- Talent Surveys done quarterly to ascertain a Member's talents, hobbies, and interests.
- Putting Masons to work utilizing the Talent Surveys in order to keep them cheerfully laboring in the quarries.
- Masonic Travel.
- Masonic Social Engagement.

This would be the minimum expectation of what a Lodge should be doing and give the candidate a standard of excellence in high-quality education that he may expect from the Lodge. The Lodge may and should be encouraged to exceed the minimum standards; but at the very least, the Jurisdiction can start on the same page.

*** SEE APPENDIX C - For further information.**

This leaves Freemasonry's weakest sections of the four-point approach to the Total Membership Committee: Restoration & Attraction.

Restoration should, in my opinion, have an office within the Grand Lodge (like a committee) - that has an open-door policy to all Master Mason's. This requires the patience of Job, the wisdom of Solomon, the strength of Peter, and the compassion of Paul. This can be accomplished through many open, honest, and efficacious conversations. Both at the Grand Lodge and Lodge Level, a team assembled for the purpose of restoring a Master Mason to his former usefulness armed with the proper resources to accomplish this task.

Some questions that need to be asked are:

- Was he suspended or expelled?
- Was this a disciplinary measure?
- Was the suspension due to Non-Payment of Dues?
- Was his exit from Masonry voluntary?
- Was his exit from Masonry due to a personal conflict?
- Was his exit from Masonry due to personal or financial hardships?
- Was his exit from Masonry due to Health?
- Was his exit from Masonry due to Religious conflicts?
- Was his exit from Masonry due to relationship conflicts?
- Was his exit from Masonry due to disillusionment?
- Was his exit from Masonry due to a miscommunication or misunderstanding?
- Was his exit from Masonry due to neglect?
- Was his exit from Masonry due to a lack of education?
- Most importantly, if reasonable, Can something be done to restore that Membership?

Attraction is a problematic area for Freemasonry. The first shortcoming we tend to be guilty of is our approach towards Marketing, Branding, Public Relations, Understanding our Demographic, Precision Target Marketing, Consistency, and Apologetics (for lack of a better phrase). We will be discussing this at length, a little later in this discussion.

*** What are the needs of the Members?**

- **Fraternal** – These are men, who seek a Brotherhood. Anyone can hold a membership. My library card states that I am a Member. So does my card to Cosco, Sam's Club, the gym, et cetera. Being a member means that you can use the services provided within your membership agreement. I can make friends anywhere. Friends often come and go. A Brotherhood is a shared bond. Within Freemasonry – the shared bond of the mystic tie is merely a springboard meant to propel you into something higher, and deeper. Becoming a family should be the goal.
- **Ritual** – One of the most neglected resources continues to be our Ritual. Ritual performance, conferral, and instruction should be considered as sacred as our Brotherhood itself. We should be focused on surpassing simple rote memorization and elevating our knowledge and understanding of what we are saying, why we say it, from whence it came, and how these lessons apply to the individual member's personal life. That begins and ends with Masonic Ritual and remains the greatest resource of education and esoteric knowledge.
- **Educational** – Instruction on every level is a must. No one wants to join another business meeting where the focus is paying the bills, reading the minutes of the last meeting, or painfully sitting through an ad hoc committee meeting/report holding the business meeting hostage. Unless there is a vote or motion to be brought to the floor, or an announcement to be made – Committees should act as a trustee and perform their labors outside the meeting

of that Masonic Body. Meetings should be educational, informative, thought-provoking, and fun.

- **Social** – Time, energy, talent, and efforts are precious commodities; ones that should never be wasted. If we take the time to include a social hour – Whether light refreshments or a family-styled potluck dinner opportunity is provided – and we open this 1 to 1 ½ hour prior to the meeting – to create a space where families and all Master Masons and their families are encouraged to attend; then we create a time to bond, and to enjoy fellowship whilst cultivating our Brotherhood and incorporating our family-life in one space and time. This will lead to future opportunities.
- **Charitable** – With the several Masonic Charities including: RARA, CMMRF, KTEF, Holy Land Pilgrimage, JROTC Programs, and Educational Scholarship Programs – Our charity seems to be spread a bit thin. Taking on additional Charities might make our efforts weakened – One such Idea could be to leave out a York Rite Charities collection jar for cash and check donations; and divide it among the agreed-upon Charities every quarter.
- **Community** – Supporting our community in a meaningful way should be our goal and a constant discussion. Letting the public know that Freemasons are an active partner and neighbor is necessary for the health of everyone. Parades (should they be allowed) merely put a public face on Freemasonry. Investing time into our community will create opportunity for an open dialogue between the public and our sacred Brotherhood.
- **Mentorship** - In a Lodge, we teach them to listen to a coach and seek out mentors that will assist them in their journeys. We must develop a support network of mentorship among the membership as well as with our Leaders. No one will rise to labor among us if they feel abandoned or as if we only desired their membership and dues. While we rebuild the Masonic Family and are still learning ourselves, we must seek to mentor others to embrace the lifestyle as a Freemason. We must assist them in their ritual, education, knowledge, understanding, and growth in the Fraternity and in Life.
- **Recognition** – Awards, and award programs are some of the greatest tools for inspiration and motivation. If we view them as a cheap ‘atta-boy’ or just another ‘pat on the back’ then we neglect how effective they are at creating positive energy and creative momentum within the Masonic Family. A win for 1 Member is a win for the entire Jurisdiction. Recognizing the efforts of a hardworking Freemasons validates his sacrifice and efforts – while motivating others to follow suit.
- **Leadership Opportunity** – Healthy competition and a sincere ambition for duty and service should always be encouraged. The brand, culture, and vision of a Masonic Body takes dedicated and qualified leadership. None of which can be nurtured or strengthened if new Members are not afforded opportunity to lead and to learn how to lead. Leaders are not born, they are forged and tempered. We must learn from the past; and look to the future of the Masonic Bodies we serve. How have we trained our replacements? Did we instill confidence within them by training them, educating, them, leading by example, and affording

them the freedom to make mistakes – while giving them the opportunity to learn from their mistakes and to lead others towards success?

This was one side of the coin that favored the member. The other side of the coin revealed areas that required attention and caution.

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There are 3 gates in Freemasonry, that we need to watch:

- a. The West Gate – Who we admit into the Fraternity
- b. The South Gate – Who leaves the Fraternity
- c. The East Gate – Who we elect to lead the Fraternity.

Each can do an immeasurable amount of greatness or damage to the health and prosperity of Freemasonry. Here's a bit of hard truth. Not every man deserves to enter the West Gate.

Freemasonry does not take okay men, or bad men and make them good. Freemasonry admits men of good moral character and judgement, who meet the requirements for membership, and entrusts these men with the working tools that will aid them in their journey to become better versions of the man they were the day before.

Not every Mason has met the requirement to enter the East Gate...we need to be okay with that... It is a meritorious honor... it is earned, it is not their right. There are appointed and elected chairs a Mason should experience that should inspire him to become trained and desire to serve the craft – well before he has met all the necessary requirements that make him eligible to be elected to the Oriental Chair.

In the South Gate, who we let slip away is our greatest sin...for here we equally fail to employ the lessons of Freemasonry... Both by those who slip away, and to each man who calls himself Brother. A greater attention and further focus should be paid to these Gates; and in many instances this can be corrected through further training both to the members and Officers.

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Both sides of this coin deserve further attention if we are to create an environment of success for the Masonic Family. Some of the practices we should abandon are the “my year” attitude, and the “Silver Bullet Solution”. The Masonic Family should seek a perpetual 7-to-10-year vision. Visions should be goal oriented, fluid, flexible, and adopted by the entire Corps of Officers.

“No plan of operations extends with any certainty beyond the first encounter with the main enemy forces.” - Prussian Field Marshal Helmuth von Moltke (the Elder) 1871

“The surest way of achieving your goal is through the single-minded pursuit of simple actions.”

SLIDE # 13 -

A plan of action is invaluable to success; but no plan should remain inflexible. In either words - Be like Water:

“Empty your mind, be formless. Shapeless, like water. If you put water into a cup, it becomes the cup. You put water into a bottle and it becomes the bottle. You put it in a teapot, it becomes the teapot. Now, water can flow or it can crash. Be water, my friend.” – Bruce Lee

Growing up in a military household we were taught the values of Constant Forward Motion and perpetual review.

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C.S. Lewis wrote, “There are far better things ahead than we ever leave behind.” This does not mean that we forget the lessons of the past, but that in a state of Constant Forward Motion we avoid the paralysis of indecision and being overly cautious. Through Constant Forward Motion and perpetual review – we remain fluid, adapting to the situation, improvising when it is necessary, and ready to meet every challenge prepared to overcome any obstacle, and evolve. Perpetual review affords us the opportunity to revisit our decisions; and take advantage of experience; while correcting our mistakes in order to ensure success.

SLIDE # 15 -

Let’s review a model applied to Freemasonry that does not quite fit our needs.

Abandon the “business model” – A business is defined as an organization or enterprising entity engaged in commercial, industrial, or professional activities for the sole purpose of the pursuit of equitable and profitable compensation in exchange for the products or services provided.

Freemasonry is neither a charity, nor is it a business. Freemasonry is not a commodity, nor a product or service. It cannot be publicly nor privately traded. It cannot be sold to the general public. Once I

take ownership of my membership, I cannot offer Freemasonry in trade, nor offer it in barter; I cannot gift my membership to anyone; nor can I sell or transfer my membership to anyone. I cannot lend my membership or allow anyone to borrow it.

Business Model:

- Creates a commodity, product, or service
- Finds a way to reduce unit costs and increase production
- Quantity is valued above quality
- Finance oriented and sales driven
- Prioritizes profits and the return on Investments
- Seeks customers
- Fosters politics and cutthroat competition
- Seeks to create workers
- Workers are often seen as expendable/ replaceable
- Extends the financial responsibility entirely to the customer
- Advancement opportunities are rare
- Leadership training is often restricted
- Compartmentalizes life – Prioritizes Work over Home Life
- Charity is often used as a tax-shelter or as a PR Stunt

SLIDE # 16 –

Let's shift your perspective, and review a model not yet applied to Freemasonry that might fit our needs a little better.

We call each other Brother, in various forms and teach Brotherly Love as a core value or tenet of Freemasonry. We establish our mystic tie and shared bonds as the foundation of our Fraternity. By the very framework of Freemasonry, we are a family. We invest time into each other in hopes to build each other up, and see every Mason reach his full potential and achieve his goals. Therefore, I believe we should adopt the "Family Model".

– A family is defined as a group of people united by certain convictions or a common affiliation; such as a common language, purpose, bond, stock or household. By this definition, Freemasonry immediately comes to mind.

"The greatest title I ever earned is Brother." -Illustrious William A. Powell, Sr., PGM, 33°,

SLIDE # 17 -

A family is more of an organic experience. A family:

- Creates a culture of peace, harmony, strength, and unity.
- Is steeped in tradition, respecting their roots; while ever evolving
- Teaches its newest members how to walk, act, and talk as a member with the desire that he will both lead the family while creating new members.
- Has several branches that gain strength from the same roots
- Has responsibilities, incurs debts, and pays bills
- Has a code they live by
- Holds an expectation that each member will once he has attained a certain level of equality - pay his fair share, accept equal responsibility, perpetuate family tradition/culture, and uphold the code.
- Offers correction and discipline; not out of pettiness or malice; but rather out of love and with the hopes that the member will reach their full potential and exceed expectations.
- Hopes that each member embodies a way of life, becomes the very model of the family name, and better than the generation before.
- Avoids divisiveness, politics, unhealthy competition and toxic ambition
- Celebrates and encourages the success of each member.
- Is selective about whom they adopt, and does not actively, nor openly recruit new membership.
- Much like the adoption process, a Family does not openly recruit; but rather privately discerns whether the family and the adoptee are a right fit for each other. Quality is valued above quantity
- Helps each member grow
- Mentors' new members, encourages leadership opportunities, and service to the family.
- Hopes to be fruitful and perpetually adopt new members.
- and is subject to public opinion and judgment.

Like any successful family, business practices are employed to increase the safety, security, and stability of the Family. Most especially in the areas of finance, and when dealing with the public or as legal issues arise. And just like any family, legitimacy and recognition are in a state of perpetual review. We have healthy debates, differences in opinions, and at times, we need mediators and peacekeepers to solve misunderstandings and ensure that peace and harmony which is our strength. As with any modern family, we come from almost every walk of life. What separates us from any other fraternity or volunteer organization – is in the fact that in Freemasonry – we are a true Brotherhood.

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“Great Friends become family. They treat each other like Brothers. They understand that it’s not just a word. It holds a deeper meaning when you put Masonry into action.” -Illustrious Lorenzo E. Tibbitts, PGM, 33°, Secretary General Orient of Utah Valley of Salt Lake Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite, SJ, USA,

With this view in mind, I believe that we must focus our energy in branding, precision targeting of our key demographic, and the 'Total Membership Committee.

SLIDE # 19 -

The Law of Attraction is the ability to attract into our lives whatever we are focusing on. It is believed that regardless of age, nationality or religious belief, we are all susceptible to the laws which govern the Universe, including the Law of Attraction. It is the Law of Attraction which uses the power of the mind to translate whatever is in our thoughts and materialize them into reality.

The attitude, energy, and self-perception you project is a mere reflection of who you will attract into your life and of course your Lodge. In other words, if you embody Brother love, adopt a positive attitude, remain grateful for the opportunity to serve the Craft, and rush to build your Brethren up in hopes that they will prosper – This will become the archetype of the Aspirants that knock at the doors of your Lodge. When your actions influence the culture of your Lodge, this becomes your branding and how the world perceives Freemasonry. More than a square and compasses visibly seen by the world; Freemasonry becomes synonymous with Morality and Brotherhood; Freemasonry becomes tangibly desired as a need in the life of good men.

SLIDE # 20 -

In order to understand our target audience / key demographics we need to comb through the data left behind in the petitions. When extracting the data regarding Membership I asked the following questions:

- What was the age of the Aspirant, at the time the petition was submitted, accepted or read in Lodge for the first time?
- What is the age range of the membership when they petitioned?
- What was the average age of the petitioner?

- Is he still a member of the Lodge?
- How long has he been a member?
- How many years has he remained a member?

SLIDE # 21 -

I dug deep within the archives of several Lodges, and from 1874 to the present day, the data reflected some interesting results. What I discovered is that throughout history:

- 15% of the Membership who petition Lodges in the 18-24 Age Range.
- 60% of the Membership who petition Lodges in the 25-44 Age Range.
- 15% of the Membership who petition Lodges in the 45-54 Age Range.
- 10% of the Membership who petition Lodges in the 55+ Age Range.

The average age of men who apply for Membership in Freemasonry is 33 years old.

Of the men who become Freemasons between the age of 25yrs to 44yrs old - the Lodge sees a minimum of 27 years of active service in the Lodge.

Source:

- Golden Spike Lodge No. 6 Free and Accepted Masons of Utah Membership petitions, Rosters, Minutes, & Histories.
- Weber Lodge No. 6 Free and Accepted Masons of Utah Membership petitions, Rosters, Minutes, & Histories.
- George Washington Lodge No. 24 Free and Accepted Masons of Utah Membership petitions, Rosters, Minutes, & Histories.

In doing a casual poll through social media to see if the same were true from US Lodges in other Grand Jurisdictions nearly all I spoke to said that they fit into the same category as the 60% of men who joined a Lodge in between the age of 25 to 44 years old at the time of petitioning a Lodge.

This establishes that 6 out of 10 Brethren were at between the ages of 25 to 44 years old by the time they joined a Lodge and began their journey with us. With the focus on that range, the requirement for lawful aged Candidates have been satisfied. How about some of the other basic requirements?

Source:

Social Media –

Facebook, Instagram, reddit, TikTok

SLIDE # 22 -

For this part of the discussion, I am going to reach for low-hanging fruit: the Beehive State.

Utah is one of the fastest-growing states in the US. Weber County alone is expected to nearly double its population in the next 10 to 30 years.

Source:

[https://www.usnews.com/news/best-states/utah/articles/2021-01-10/utah-still-among-fastest-growing-states-though-boom-](https://www.usnews.com/news/best-states/utah/articles/2021-01-10/utah-still-among-fastest-growing-states-though-boom-slowed#:~:text=SALT%20LAKE%20CITY%20(AP)%20%E2%80%94,Bureau%2C%20the%20Deseret%20News%20reported.)

[slowed#:~:text=SALT%20LAKE%20CITY%20\(AP\)%20%E2%80%94,Bureau%2C%20the%20Deseret%20News%20reported.](https://www.usnews.com/news/best-states/utah/articles/2021-01-10/utah-still-among-fastest-growing-states-though-boom-slowed#:~:text=SALT%20LAKE%20CITY%20(AP)%20%E2%80%94,Bureau%2C%20the%20Deseret%20News%20reported.)

<https://archive.slttrib.com/article.php?id=57833427&itype=CMSID>

https://www.standard.net/news/government/weber-county-growth-and-development-issues-loomed-large-throughout-2020/article_57b209c3-708d-59b9-af39-f0544a65ace4.html

SLIDE # 23 -

Arguably, Utah remains one of the safest and healthiest places to raise a family. Utah is also ranked one of the most affordable places for college students.

Source:

<https://www.cnbc.com/2019/02/19/moneyrates-the-10-best-states-to-raise-a-family.html>

SLIDE # 24 -

The current population is more than 3.2 Million citizens in Utah. Approximately 49% are Male.

Source:

<https://www.census.gov/quickfacts/UThttps://www.infoplease.com/us/census/utah/demographic-statisticshttps://gardner.utah.edu/wp-content/uploads/Utah-Popest-CountySYAS-May2019.pdf>

The average age of Males in Utah is 28 years old.

Source:

<https://suburbanstats.org/population/how-many-people-live-in-utah>

<https://www.worldlifeexpectancy.com/usa/utah-life-expectancy-by-county-male>

https://data.bls.gov/timeseries/LASST490000000000005?amp%253bdata_tool=XGtable&output_view=data&include_graphs=truehttps://datausa.io/profile/geo/utah

<https://www.usawage.com/popular/jobs-state-utah.php>

SLIDE # 30 -

That leaves more than 261,600 Utah residents who meet most of the prerequisites for membership in Freemasonry- here in Utah.

Source:

The Masonic Code Of The Most Worshipful Grand Lodge Of Free and Accepted Masons Of Utah - Title III - Regulations Relative To Lodges
CHAPTER VI. MEMBERSHIP AND JURISDICTION & CHAPTER
VII. CANDIDATES.

SLIDE # 31 -

Understanding our Demographics includes defining who we are and who we hope to admit into our Brotherhood. We are a Society of Friends, a Brotherhood, and more. Who we are cannot be more clearly defined than within the Mission Statement:

"The mission of Freemasonry in Utah is to teach and perpetuate a way of life that promotes brotherhood, self-improvement through education, high moral standards, charitable action, and community involvement."

SLIDE # 32 -

Let's break that down:

"The mission of Freemasonry in Utah is:

- To Teach
- To Perpetuate
 - A Way Of Life That Promotes:
 - Brotherhood
 - Self-Improvement Through:
 - Education
 - High Moral Standards
 - Charitable Action
 - Community Involvement

- "To teach a way of life
- And to promote a way of life
 - A way of life that promotes Brotherhood
 - A way of life that promotes Self-improvement
 - A way of life that promotes Self-improvement through Education
 - A way of life that promotes Self-improvement through High Moral Standards
 - A way of life that promotes Self-improvement through Charitable Action
 - A way of life that promotes Self-improvement through Community Involvement.

You'll notice here above in our mission statement – it does not suggest that the "...mission of Freemasonry in Utah is to teach and perpetuate a way of life that promotes..." friendship.

No, the operative word is Brotherhood.

We are designed to create a family amongst our friends. Here the emphasis is family. With that, comes an emotional investment and a desire to fulfill mission success, by ensuring we develop the very best by giving the very best.

This is who we are, and what we must seek to attract. The Law of Attraction states that you will attract into your life whatever you focus on. Whatever you give your energy and attention to will come back to you.

So, what do we need?

Freemasonry needs droves and waves of young men eligible for admission, who desire to dedicate themselves to the mission statement as defined by our respective grand jurisdictions. This is the 60% of our Demographic who petitions the Lodge; making this age and this mission our key demographic. This is where our leading energy and effort needs to be invested.

Source:

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SLIDE # 33 -

Attraction.

How do we reach our key demographic? Communication is vital; but more importantly, it is the method or platform the public uses to receive information that will make the greatest difference. As we have all learned, we live in a technologically driven society. Freemasonry must adapt. Technology must become a tool in our arsenal.

In order to inform, entice, and attract new members we must understand that social media has created a new standard: “the 7-second algorithm is the new elevator speech”.

This is not the time to exploit the bumper sticker advertisement. Do not use phrases like “2B1ASK1” (To be one, ask one) or “Freemasonry: Making Good Men Better”. To the aspirant, you might as well be speaking a foreign language and telling him to get lost. These phrases fall on deaf ears. And are of little to no help to anyone.

Convenience is what’s right in front of them. To be convenient, we must be visible. Our digital footprint must be stronger. We need to be present in the public’s thought process when they are most likely to be on social media, and to do that we need to implement a targeted, data-driven marketing strategy that involves reaching the right citizen at the right time, with the right message through the right channel or media platform; in order to single out our target audience.

An established SEO/SMO (Search Engine/Social Media Optimization) Network is only the beginning.

The human mind was built for visual information:

- 90% of the information processed by the brain is visual.
- It takes only 13 milliseconds for the human brain to process an image.
- When people hear information, they’re likely to remember only 10% of that information three days later.
- However, if a relevant image is paired with that same information, people retained 65% of the information three days later.

Which leads us to the understanding that words alone are never enough. The human mind needs stimulus and desires interaction.

The 7 second algorithm is simple. Create short videos that engages viewers from the start. Make your message simple and relevant. Post when your audience is most active; speaking to an empty room only helps when we practice ritual. Post often; the internet is constantly refreshing. You will get lost in the noise if you only post once a month. Use trending sounds and music in your videos providing that it does not compete with the sound of your voice. Engage and connect with other Social Media users. Social media, networking is especially important. Make sure to leave comments and engage on other people's posts.

Be genuine, and make sure to show that you care about the topics you discuss. If you aren't genuine in your engagements, this can backfire and cause you to lose followers. Algorithms for social media platforms may need investigation to determine how to become more relevant to consumers. While there are set tips and tricks to follow, some may be more well-received than others.

Every 7 seconds, provide a visual and audio cue that brings the audience back to your message. In the field of behavioral sciences, this stimulates the dopamine loop.

"The dopamine system is especially sensitive to "cues" that a reward is coming (remember Ivan Pavlov?). If there is a small, specific cue that signifies that something is going to happen, that sets off our dopamine system. So when there is a sound (auditory cue) or a visual cue that a notification has arrived, that cue enhances the addictive effect. It's not the reward itself that keeps the dopamine loop going; it's the anticipation of the reward. Robert Sapolsky talks about this anticipation/dopamine connection in his research." - Susan Weinschenk, Ph.D. – Psychology Today.

By stimulating the audience with audio and visual cues every 7 seconds pointing back to your message; then your message becomes the reward in the subconscious of the viewer. This is the purpose of the 7 second algorithm; and can be another tool in your arsenal.

SLIDE # 34 -

Multimedia coupled with the appropriate audio and visual cues is paramount to delivering our message. A little more than 58.% of the world's population are active social media users, spending an average of nearly 2 and 1/2 hours accessing social media each day.

Connecting the Top Social Media Apps together is an effective way to get your message out.

- **Facebook**
 - Users: 2.93 billion monthly active users
 - Sub-apps: Facebook Page, Messenger, groups
- **YouTube**
 - Users: 2.56 billion monthly active users
- **WhatsApp**
 - Users: 2 billion monthly active users
- **Instagram**
 - Users: 2 billion monthly active users
 - Sub-apps: Instagram Reels
- **WeChat**
 - Users: 1.26 billion monthly active users
- **TikTok**
 - Users: 1 billion monthly active users
- **Facebook Messenger**
 - Users: 0.99 billion monthly active users
- **Douyin (TikTok – in China)**
 - Users: 0.60 billion monthly active users
- **QQ (Tencent)**
 - Users: 0.57 billion monthly active users
- **Sina Weibo**
 - Users: 0.57 billion monthly active users
- **Kuaishou**
 - Users: 0.57 billion monthly active users
- **Shapchat**
 - Users: 0.56 billion monthly active users
- **Telegram**
 - Users: 0.55 billion monthly active users
- **Pinterest**
 - Users: 0.44 billion monthly active users
- **Twitter**
 - Users: 0.44 billion monetizable monthly active users
- **LinkedIn**
 - Users: 830 million monthly active users
- **Reddit**
 - Users: 1.5 billion monthly active users
- **Quora**
 - Users: 0.30 billion monthly active users

- **Clubhouse**
 - Users: 10 million weekly active users
- **Discord**
 - Users: 300 million registered users, 50 million were added in 2019.

Video marketing – Videos are highly engaging and interactive in nature. A good quality video can catch the attention of the viewer easily.

Blog posts and articles – Written content may not work as well as videos and images, but it still helps you get the attention of your audience. Just make sure that you write about topics that are of interest to your target audience and are useful to them.

Social media content – You can connect with your target audience through social media platforms as well. Through a combination of images, videos, and text, you can engage and reach them more efficiently.

Studies reveal that there are peak days, and peak hours to increase the visibility of your posts, and to make them more effective.

- Monday: 6AM, 10AM, and 10PM EST
- Tuesday: 2AM, 4AM, and 9AM EST
- Wednesday: 7AM, 8AM, and 11PM EST
- Thursday: 9AM, 12PM, and 7PM EST
- Friday: 5AM, 1PM, and 3PM EST
- Saturday: 11AM, 7PM, and 8PM EST
- Sunday: 7AM, 8AM, and 4PM EST

Monday through Wednesday appear to be the best days to post on Platforms like Facebook.

Whereas Twitter, Reddit, and Quora's peak day is Tuesday.

Video and photo-based apps such as Youtube, TikTok, SnapChat, and Instagram's peak days are Wednesday through Friday.

Lives such as Facebook live, TikTok Live, and Discord perform best at the latest Peak Hour during their latest Peak Day.

Exploiting the peak hours, days, and platforms can give you the best results we seek.

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SLIDE # 35 -

Integrating your SEO/SMO through a platform such as MailChimp can give you the advantage of spreading your message to multiple Social Media Apps simultaneously. All of which should drive web traffic back to a website, email address, and a point of contact. Carrying on the conversation through communication apps such as MS Teams and Signal can help keep the attention of the Aspirant.

SLIDE # 36 -

Of course, the power of the Hashtags can help your content stay competitive in the algorithm. You'll notice there are a few rules to the Hashtag that will give your posts the leading edge. 3 to 5 Hashtags relevant to your message will boost your visibility. Here are some simple rules to follow:

Do:

- Use hashtags relevant to your content.
- Use them consistently.
- Make them easy to remember — and spell.
- Your research. Check which hashtags your fans already use and follow.
- Mix well-known and niche hashtags to broaden your discoverability.
- Use specific hashtags so your fans can easily search for your content.
- Give people a reason to use your hashtag.
- Partner with influencers or followers.
- Use branded hashtags.
- Follow the rule of 3 to 5 hashtags.

Don't:

- Over-hashtag. 6 Hashtags is 1 too many.
- Use hashtags that are too generic or have nothing to do with your content.
- Expect people to use your hashtag without a reason.
- Neglect to educate on what it is and how to use it.
- Use all CAPS LOCK.
- Use divisive or controversial phrases in your Hashtags.

Ultimately, it is the conversation and the face-to-face interaction that is necessary to begin the journey from Aspirant to Member in Good Standing.

Social Media allows us to begin the conversation. The goal in mind is to turn Social Media content into a handshake and a cup of coffee. Our primary goal is the in-person MeetUp Group events. Public social interaction is where we begin the screening process.

As we are a family, we encourage the social hour - like dinners, and family-style potlucks, at least 60 to 90 minutes prior to every business meeting, or degree. Our family, friends, and Aspirants are encouraged to attend and to participate in our public/social interactions. The invitations are sent out through communication apps such as Signal, Facebook Page events, Mailchimp, and MS Teams which allow the admins to create public, Officer Corps and Lodge room Chat rooms.

Public Chat rooms allow the membership to engage the Public daily – in between social events.

Again, with the goal of bringing the Aspirant to that face-to-face interaction. Here, over casual conversations, questions can be answered, and concerns can be addressed.

At no time should we allow the ball to be dropped. The biggest concern is that often we get them in, and Raised to the Sublime Degree of Master Mason, and then leave them to their own designs. This can and must be corrected.

SLIDE # 37 –

Attention.

Now that their interests are piqued and they are ready to get to know us and begin their journey as an Aspirant, we need to begin on the right foot with the public. We are taught that, "...to be good and true is the first lessons we are taught in Masonry." We need to be honest and have integrity. We must engage in open dialogues with the public.

Financial realities should be one of our conversations upfront. I have heard Aspirants being informed that a Mason should expect to pay on average, approximately \$500.00 per year for his Blue Lodge experience. To my shock, each time I heard this open and honest conversation with many different aspirants, their reaction was of surprise. Not shock, or fear; but pleasantly surprised. The most

common expression was a sentiment of: "Is that all? I thought it would easily be "X-number" times that, at least." Let that sink in. the aspirant did the mental math, and instead of being shocked at the prospect of paying \$42.00 a month (just in the Blue/ Symbolic Lodge), their sticker shock was that they were not paying \$42.00 per week.

This alone, says we need to stop being frozen in fear and start having more candid conversations with prospective members. There are multitudes of other amazing examples where open and honest conversations inform the Aspirants of would-be deal-breakers for them. They may not have the ability to meet the demands on their time, finances, mental acuity, memory, and introspective abilities that are, in truth, required of the candidate for the mysteries. While it is not our place to make that judgement; not providing the aspirant with the facts of the matter becomes a lie of omission. We need those who are ready, willing, and able. If they do not possess the ability to devote themselves to this pursuit; it is a grave disservice to them. They may be perfect for Masonry- but this this might not be the perfect time for them to join. We should encourage their success, not ensure their failure.

Another practice we must see an end to is well-meaning Brethren who are eager to spread misinformation; either intentionally or unwittingly. When we repeat Masonic Myths we hurt the fraternity. We need to nip this weed in the roots; before it buds. The 'Goat' is not Masonic; nor has it ever been a part of Freemasonry. Freemasons did not influence or design The Great Seals of the United States of America. Freemasons did not hide or smuggle the Templar Treasure over to the New World. The Forget-Me-Not flower was not used to identify one Mason to another during World War II. Many research papers have established these to be no more than myth. Not truth, not fact; but no more than a tall-tale repeated by well-meaning Brethren who unwittingly turn misinformation into disinformation. Aspirants deserve much better from a fraternity who will redefine their standards.

Finally, the last nail in our coffin is the element of despair. When we hear that it will take an additional 10,000 newly made Masons to stabilize even the most intimate of Grand Jurisdictions, those Masons on the frontlines and in the trenches tend to hit the panic button. Out of that panic creates a fight or flight response. Those who attempt to create a mass exodus perceive that they are leaving a sinking ship; and end up throwing out the Baby with the Bathwater. Others tend to solicit the views of Chicken Little and stand about preaching their apocalyptic viewpoints. So convinced of

the death of Freemasonry, that they stand ready to shove her off the cliff; just so they can be in the right and stand up at the eulogy and scream, "I told you so!"

Still others stand on the sales floor ready to modify, mold, and shape Freemasonry into the profane's image of what the world's oldest and largest fraternity should be. To this well-meaning Brother, all of Freemasonry's troubles will be solved by the numbers. For him, the only solution appears to be that Freemasonry is like a used car. Here we stroll out to his bargain basement priced lot where we must slash prices, throw in extras for free, and modify the car exhaustively until we make the customer happy. Here, the Customer is Master, and we must "Sale! Sale! Sale!" So desperate for the sale, that often Membership requirements get ignored or overlooked; rules get suspended and broken, Grand Lodge Code is tossed out with standards of quality. Any man with a portion of the degree fees and a pulse is marched right in; and machined through the degrees without personal growth or even the most basic catechism proficiency requirements.

To the Aspirant, this attitude of despair is disparaging and often turns them away. Would the passengers of the Titanic board if the Captain assured their voyage would be short-lived and doomed? No aspirant wants to join a dying fraternity. Nor should we continue to promote this myth. Our Aspirants deserve better.

Then there are those Brethren, who understand that the best defense is a great offense. These Brethren know that as long as there are at least three Master Masons in the world living according to the lessons of Masonry (both inside and outside of the Lodge); that Freemasonry is very much alive and well in the hearts of great men who will usher in an age of renewal and regrowth.

Brethren, Freemasonry is not dead; Freemasonry is not dying. In the past 300 recorded years in the age of our beloved mystic tie, Freemasonry has survived persecution, war, famine, pestilence, natural disaster, theft, vandalism, prejudice, recessions, depression, exile, and worst. For one second, think about that. All that Freemasonry has endured and survived; and now, in this age- Freemasonry is going to decline and disappear off the face of the Earth unless we act in fear and desperation? No. Freemasonry will survive today, tomorrow, and long into the future past the time when even the celebrities of our Fraternity become nothing more than a footnote in the history of humanity.

"Love yourself first and everything else falls into line. You really have to love yourself to get anything done in this world." - Lucille Ball

We reference the Lodge as a Mother Lodge, likening the preparation room to a womb from which, through an initiatory experience, we are born into Freemasonry. Let us then protect our Mother, by not only recognizing that she is a woman; but by treating her like a lady with the respect she is due. Like all great women, Freemasonry must remain somewhat elusive and maintain a certain level of mystery. This will increase her beauty and appeal.

"The most beautiful thing we can experience is the mysterious. It is the source of all true art and all science. He to whom this emotion is a stranger, who can no longer pause to wonder and stand rapt in awe, is as good as dead: his eyes are closed." — Albert Einstein

I am candid with the public when I answer honestly and admit that I am fortunate enough to be a Freemason; as much as I am when I answer them that I get to attend Lodge tonight- as I stand in my Tuxedo to purchase my coffee and pay for gas before Lodge. Any further questions, I direct them to a website, Social Media site, and invite them to dine with us at a Pre-meeting dinner, and social event, or a Meetup Group. I will, however, be ever ready to dispel all myths; but I offer no more information than this. The goal is to get the Aspirant to a conversation and a cup of coffee. Here is where the real journey begins.

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Ambassador and Retention.

From the first moment we knelt where Hiram knelt; each of us accepted a mantle. In that moment, we became Ambassadors, and with that mantle was passed the Yoke of Responsibility. No matter where you are or what you are doing, to the world you are Freemasonry. Regardless of whether you are wearing every symbol possible or there is not so much as a single Masonic ring, or lapel pin on your person – you are someone's image of Freemasonry. This is not something you can turn on and off like a light switch.

As an ambassador to Freemasonry, you should desire to become a mentor to every Brother you interact with. Mentors should be shepherds and guides. Mentors should help the individual Brother along his Masonic Journey.

The number one goal of every Mentor is to keep the Brethren engaged. It is not the sole responsibility of the Lodge to provide programming or to drive the Brethren to continue to study the mysteries. A mentor can be holding those discussions outside of Lodge.

You should be gauging where the Brethren are. Have they been introduced to the entire Masonic Family? Often, I begin as early as the Fellow Craft Degree. I will repeat the steps taken that we've discussed here today. I will invite our Fellowcraft and Master Masons – and their families to social and public events and family-style potlucks. I will engage them through emails, and social media. I will text them out of the blue and just ask them how their day is.

SLIDE # 38 -

“Masonic labor is purely a labor of love. He who seeks to draw Masonic wages in gold and silver will be disappointed. The wages of a Mason are in the dealings with one another; sympathy begets sympathy, kindness begets kindness, helpfulness begets helpfulness, and these are the wages of a Mason.” – Benjamin Franklin

Companions, I believe that it is our sacred duty to elevate each of our Brethren; and to help guide them in the pursuit of good and wholesome instructions in the pursuit of their Masonic labors- labors dedicated to building that spiritual temple' that house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens; a pure and spotless building, a fit residence of Him who dwelleth with the good.

A Mason forms each stone of that temple by the application the working tools he gains. Each degree is another tool, and another chance he gets to square his work; and to complete his Spiritual Temple. We hold him back, when he is not exposed to the degrees, he has rightful access to.

SLIDE # 39 -

"A Brother who joins the Ancient & Accepted Scottish Rite and/or the York Rite - is 30% to 45% LESS likely to leave Freemasonry." - Illustrious James Dean Cole, 33° Sovereign Grand Commander, Supreme Council 33° AASR, Southern Jurisdiction (Mother Council of the World), USA

Illustrious Jim Cole, 33° made this claim due to a study performed with the cooperation of our Grand Lodges, both Rites, and the Shrine. The results of this study were very revealing. This means that if you love your Brother, it is imperative that we help that Brother to join the Rites of Freemasonry. When a Brother joins the York and Scottish Rite – it does not just benefit that Valley, Chapter, Council, or Commandery – In fact, we help the Lodge grow as well as the Brother.

The myth that the Rites of Freemasonry and the whole of the Masonic Family somehow distracts or takes Brethren away from the Lodge is simply not true. If anything, participation in the Rites of Freemasonry enhances and augments the individual experiences. Often York Rite and Scottish Rite Masons tend to become more active in their Blue Lodge.

I assist more than six Lodges in my Masonic Jurisdiction, I am Chaplain of my home Lodge, and Worshipful Master of Camp Floyd Historic Lodge No. 00. Masonic travel is one of the greatest tools for personal growth. I get to meet Brethren from around the Jurisdiction, hold conversations over refreshments, and get to know them on a personal level, as well as their Masonic interests, needs and goals.

This information alone, allows me to guide them along their Masonic Journey. Before they've finished their first beverage, I've emailed them a petition or information regarding a portion of the Masonic family that meets their needs. Even if I am not a part of that Rite, club, or body – I have a

petition, information regarding that interest and the point of contact that can assist them – in their email or Facebook Messenger. Additionally, I've carbon copied that Point of Contact in that communication, in order to facilitate the next step in their Masonic journey.

SLIDE # 40

In 1907, (Lord) Lieutenant-General Robert Stephenson Smyth Baden-Powell, 1st Baron Baden-Powell, OM, GCMG, GCVO, KCB, KStJ, an English soldier, devised the Scout motto: "Be Prepared."

He published it in *Scouting for Boys* in 1908. (Two years later, in 1910, the Boy Scouts of America was founded.) - Upon hearing the Scout motto, someone asked Scouting founder Robert Baden-Powell the inevitable follow-up question. "Prepared for what?"

"Why, for any old thing," he replied.

In *Scouting for Boys*, Baden-Powell wrote that to Be Prepared means "you are always in a state of readiness in mind and body to do your duty."

We must Lead by example – We ask this of the children of our communities – We should expect no less out of ourselves. We should familiarize ourselves with every part of the Masonic Family, and Be Prepared - ever ready to field questions, and give the most accurate information. I will often follow up handful of times, with the Brethren I assist along their journey in whatever form of communication they prefer.

To summarize, if we lead by example, both inside as well as outside the Lodge Freemasonry becomes the Family we create. Through a positive mental attitude, an attitude of gratitude, and the Law of Attraction – we will embody and attract the right Aspirants for Freemasonry. By understanding our target audience and communicating on the platforms most utilized by them, we can deliver the right message at the right times to the right audience, with greater success. Through our success we can gain that desired face-to-face meeting and begin the process from Aspirant to Petitioner. Once they gain the ability to vote in a Lodge, our responsibility to them has just begun. Mentorship should be a lifelong journey and should begin with the first handshake. Our goal should be the constant cycle of attraction, attention, and retention with ever Brother within our Masonic Family.

SLIDE # 41

The Challenge – A Call to Action.

I have called each of you here today, Companion, ambassador, and mentor. I have enjoyed our time together, and hopefully you have generated ideas that you are inspired to try. One Mentor cannot bear the work alone. This should be the perpetual goal of every member of our family.

Companions and Mentors, Freemasonry is growing, but in order to maintain a healthy and vigorous growth, it requires hard work, dedication, and the Love of Brethren who are ready to work.

You can be the reason for our success. You can help usher in a new era for Freemasonry.

All you need to do is accept a challenge...You are greatest asset to our future...

The challenge is here:

The 5-4-3-2-1 Challenge.

This is a six month challenge, and can be renewed twice a year. You play a vital role in its success.

How does it work, you might ask?

Well I'm glad you asked; and teeming with pride that you've volunteered to accept the challenge!

You are truly amazing! Thank you!!

You are hereby Challenged to:

SLIDE # 42 -

5 – Introduce. Introduce Freemasonry to 5 qualifying men that you meet or know. (What are the qualifiers? The qualifies are the Prerequisites to join a Lodge, Chapter, Council, Commandery, Valley, et cetera as outlined in the respective governing Masonic Codes/Laws that are adopted by the Grand Bodies of the Grand Jurisdictions you reside in.)

SLIDE # 43 -

4 - Support. Assist your Lodge, York Rite Bodies, and Scottish Rite Valley in encouraging 4 existing members to serve on a committee, a community project, and/or as an Officer. Help them achieve success in their leadership goals through whatever guidance and support you can offer.

SLIDE # 44 -

3 - Create. Assist your Lodge, York Rite Bodies, and Scottish Rite Valley in creating 3 new members.

SLIDE # 45 -

2 - Restore. Assist your Lodge, York Rite Bodies, and Scottish Rite Valley in restoring at least 2 members who have been suspended for non-disciplinary action, such as non-payment of dues, or are Sojourning Masons who need to affiliate within your Jurisdiction; or who just fell to the way side regardless of their reasons.

SLIDE # 46 -

1 - Mentor. Assist your Lodge, York Rite Bodies, and Scottish Rite Valley in mentoring at least 1 new member and guide them along their Masonic Journey. Help them gain the wisdom, experience, and knowledge they seek.

SLIDE # 47 -

So what do you get by accepting the 5-4-3-2-1 Challenge?

The ultimate reward in our Brotherhood: Friends who become Family; Freemasons who become the future of our Fraternity; and Fellowship that becomes a lifetime of memories filled with strengthening our mystic tie, shared experiences, community involvement, and fun.

It is the single greatest act of Brotherly love you can offer.

Accept the challenge.

Be the reason great men still ask!

The Future is Ours!

Carpe Momentum! Seize the Moment!

SLIDE # 48 -

Thank You

**APPENDIX A –
The Masonic Family and the Invitational Orders.**

Symbolic Craft:

<https://bea Freemason.org/>

Masonic Youth:

Young Men -

Order of DeMolay International

<https://demolay.org/>

Order of Builders:

https://grandlodgeofkentucky.org/?page_id=2446#:~:text=The%20Order%20of%20The%20Builders,%2C%20on%20March%202%2C%201921.

Young Ladies -

International Order of Rainbow Girls

<https://www.gorainbow.org/>

Job's Daughters International

<https://jobsdaughtersinternational.org/>

Groups for Women:

Social Order of the Beauceant:

<http://www.knightstemplar.org/soob/>

<https://orderofbeauceant.org/>

Daughters of the Nile:

<https://daughtersofthenile.org/>

Ladies of the Oriental Shrine:

<https://www.ladiesorientalshrine.org/>

Daughters of Mokanna:

<https://daughtersofmokanna.com/>

Groups for Women and Master Masons:

White Shrine of Jerusalem

<https://supremeshrine.org/>

Order of Eastern Star:

<https://easternstar.org/>

Order of Amaranth:

<https://amaranth.org/>

Ancient Craft Masonry (York Rite)

<http://www.yorkrite.org/>

General Grand Chapter Royal Arch Masons International

<https://www.ggcrami.org/>

General Grand Council of Cryptic Masons International

<https://www.crypticmasons.org/>

Grand Encampment of Knights Templar

<http://www.knightstemplar.org/>

Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite of Freemasonry:

The Supreme Council (Mother Council of the World) of the Inspectors General Knights Commander of the House of the Temple of Solomon of the Thirty-third Degree of the Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite of Freemasonry of the Southern Jurisdiction of the United States of America:

<https://scottishrite.org/>

The Supreme Council of the Thirty-third Degree of the Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite of Freemasonry of the Northern Jurisdiction of the United States of America:

<https://scottishritenmj.org/>

The Supreme Council of the Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite of Freemasonry of Canada:

<https://scottishritecanada.ca/>

Professional and Patriotic Orders:

High Twelve International

<https://high12.org/>

National Sojourners, Inc.

<https://www.nationalsojourners.org/>

Heroes of '76 – Invitational Body of the National Sojourners, Inc.

<https://www.nationalsojourners.org/heroes-of-76/>

The Grand Order of the Sword of Bunker Hill

<http://www.swordofbunkerhill.org/>

Social Orders:

Ancient Egyptian Order of Sciots

<http://www.sciots.org/>

Tall Cedars of Lebanon

<http://www.tallcedars.org/>

Mystic Order of Veiled Prophets of the Enchanted Realm (Grotto)

<https://scgrotto.org/>

Ancient Arabic Order of Nobles of the Mystic Shrine

<https://www.shrinersinternational.org/>

Special Interest Clubs:

Geocaching Societies:

https://scottishrite.org/members_trashed/general-membership-information/chapter-valley-clubs-organizations/masonic-geocaching-society/

<https://www.facebook.com/MasonicGeocaching/>

National Camping Travelers Inc. - Masonic Family Camping Club

<https://gonct.org/>

Amateur (Ham) Radio Operator Clubs

<https://www.athensmasons.org/hiramham.html>

<https://masonicgathering.net/>

<http://www.hiramshams.net/masonic-nets/>

Utah Special Interest Groups:

Society of Ash and Stone – For More Information Contact William E. McCraw

Camp Floyd Historic Lodge No. 205

<http://www.cfhl205.org/>

Keystone Mark Master Mason Lodge No. 00

<https://www.utahyorkrite.org/keystone-mark-master-lodge-no-00>

Samuel Pal Honors Commandery No. 00 - For More Information Contact William E. McCraw

Invitational Orders:

What invitation-only bodies are there?

Aside from an invitation, what else is required to join?

Descriptions of these organizations are given below.

Societas Rosicruciana in Civitatibus Foederatis

The Rosicrucian Society (as it is otherwise called) is an order that is limited to Master Masons in good standing who profess the Christian faith.

Its grades (instead of degrees) are divided into three groups:

- First Order
 - Grade I° – Zelator
 - Grade II° – Theoricus
 - Grade III° – Practicus
 - Grade IV° – Philosophus

- Second Order
 - Grade V° – Adeptus Minor
 - Grade VI° – Adeptus Major
 - Grade VII° – Adeptus Exemptus
- Third Order
 - Grade VIII° – Magister
 - Grade IX° – Magus

There is no international entity to govern this body; there are, however, national jurisdictions such as Societas Rosicruciana in Civitatibus Foederatis in the United States of America, which is governed by its High Council.

<http://www.sricf.org/home.html>

Although you hear quite often that the following Invitational Orders/Bodies are mere “Chair Degrees” – this description is false and inaccurate. The descriptor “chair Degree” implies that by virtue of your service to the Craft, once you have occupied the head of a pre-requisite body – you are entitled to receive the invitation and the degree. Noting could be further from the truth. This can be said of all Invitational Orders/Bodies :

- You must first meet the requirements for membership,
- then you must be proposed/ recommended for membership –
 - which there is absolutely no guarantee that you will ever be proposed or recommended by the existing membership
- That Proposal must be met with a unanimous favorable ballot.
 - which there is absolutely no guarantee that the ballot will be cast in your favor
- Upon the Unanimous consent of the Body/Order -you will be sent an invitation,
 - which you must accept or reject.
- Once you have accepted the Invitation, you must pay fees for your admission and
- then you are entitled to receive that great honor.

If you get invited, at no time should you take the invitation lightly, nor belittle the honor by assuming its just a “Chair Degree”. Someone believed in you enough to

vouch for you and recommend you. It is always a great honor and should be treated as such.

Order of the Anointed High Priests or Order of the High Priesthood

This is a body and degree for those who currently serve or have served as Excellent High Priest for a Royal Arch chapter.

Council of Thrice Illustrious Master or Order of the Silver Trowel

The Order of the Silver Trowel is an order that is available only to those who have gone through the Cryptic degrees and are in good standing with their local Cryptic council.

It is conferred on present or past Illustrious Masters; its degree consists of two sections, during both of which the candidate represents young King Solomon. It is also referred to as the Order of the Anointed Kings .

The Masonic Order of Pilgrim Preceptors

The Order is based on the story of how Freemasonry came from Jerusalem to England.

Candidates are admitted to the degree of Pilgrim, which describes the journey of Freemasonry from Jerusalem to Rome.

The second degree is that of Preceptor; and explains the journey from Rome to England. The third degree is the Installation into the chair as an Illustrious Preceptor.

The ethos of the Order, and its motto, is “Fraternity, Equality and Liberty”.

The Masonic Order of Pilgrim Preceptors is an invitational Masonic Organization requiring that all candidates proposed for membership are required to be a current member of a Craft Lodge in a Craft Jurisdiction recognized by the United Grand Lodge of England and a current member of a Royal Arch Chapter in a Royal Arch Jurisdiction recognized by the Supreme Grand Holy Royal Arch Chapter of England; and further, that all candidates proposed for membership are required to be a Past Worshipful Master of a Craft Lodge and a Past First Principal, or Past High Priest, of a Royal Arch Chapter.

<https://pilgrimpreceptorsusa.org/>

Past Commanders Associations

This is a body for all past commanders of the commanderies of the Grand Encampment of Knights Templar, USA. A Past Commander may be invited to join the year after he has served as Eminent Commander of a Constituent Commandery. They meet at the annual Grand York Rite Sessions of the Grand Commandery of Knight Templar of the State.

Knight Crusader Of The Cross

The Knight Crusader of the Cross is an Invitational Honor and Degree within the York Rite system, available for present and past Eminent Commanders of a Constituent Commandery.

The body is referred to as “Asylum”.

This order was established in Florida in 1969. Like the other Invitational Honors and Degrees in the York Rite, this order meets and confers this degree at the state Grand Commandery Grand York Rite Sessions.

The initiation is opened with three brief lectures on Masonic Templary and the duties of a Commander. The candidates are then arranged according to the ritual and dubbed “Knight Crusaders of the Cross.” It ends with a brief lecture on the ancient Knight Templars and an explanation of the emblem of the order and the modes of recognition of the order. The emblem of the order is the Jerusalem Cross with the motto “Non Nobis Domine Non Nobis Sed Nomini Tua Da Gloriam” or “Not to us, not to us, O Lord, But to thy name give glory.”

<https://www.yorkriteusa.org/commandery.htm>

Sovereign Order of the Knights Preceptor

This is a body for all present and past commanders of the commanderies of the Grand Encampment of Knights Templar, USA. They meet at the annual Grand Council of the Allied Masonic Degrees.

It is governed by the Grand Chapter of the Order of Knights Preceptor.

<https://mwsite.org/sites/orderofkp/>

Knights of the York Cross of Honor

Membership in this order requires that one has served as a Worshipful Master of a Masonic lodge, as an Excellent High Priest of a Royal Arch chapter, as a Thrice Illustrious Master of a council of Royal and Select Masters, and as an Eminent Commander of a Commandery of Knights Templar.

This body is governed by its Convent General.

<https://kych.org/>

Yeoman of York

Yeoman of York is an Invitational Body. The organization exists to recognize those who have contributed extraordinary service to the Blue Lodge and to the bodies of the York Rite. The purpose of the Yeomen are to promote the York Rite, including the Symbolic (Craft) Lodge. Yeomen meet in Preceptories.

The requirements for membership in Yeoman of York:

Must be active in all four York Rite bodies.

In addition, you must meet at least one of the following qualifications:

- Be a KYCH member OR
- must be "KYCH-eligible", meaning that you have presided in all four York Rite bodies, but have not yet received KYCH.
- Be a past-presiding officer in at least one of the York Rite bodies
- Be an active York Rite member in all 4 bodies for a period of at least 5 years

Yeoman of the York has two classes of membership.

- Associate Member - a member is an active member of all four bodies and a 'KYCH eligible' is an Associate member.
 - Associate members cannot hold an office in the Preceptory.
- Active Member - when the Associate member receives KYCH he is automatically 'elevated' to full "active" membership in the Preceptory.

<https://www.yeomenofyork.org/>

Allied Masonic Degrees

This organization requires membership in the Royal Arch. Its degrees are not numerated and in the United States are as follows:

- Royal Ark Mariner
 - Installed Commander Noah
- Order of the Secret Monitor
 - Brotherhood of David and Jonathan: Induction/Admission of a Prince
 - Installed Supreme Ruler
- Order of Saint Lawrence the Martyr
 - Installed Master of St. Lawrence
- Grand Tiler of Solomon
- Knight of Constantinople
- Architect
- Grand Architect
- Superintendent
- Master of Tyre
- Excellent Master
 - Installed Sovereign Master
- Royal Order of the Red Branch of Eri and Appendant Orders including
 - Man-at-arms,
 - Esquire,
 - Knight
 - Knight Commander
 - Grand Cross
- The Order of the Scarlet Cord
- Ye Antiente Order of Corks

This body is governed by its Grand Council. There is no worldwide governing entity for this body, but there are other national jurisdictions.

<https://amdusa.org/wp/>

The Scarlet Cord

The Ancient and Masonic Order of the Scarlet Cord was consecrated as a sovereign body on July 21, 2010, at Freemasons' Hall in London. The order originally dated back to 1889 and existed as a sister organization to the Order of the Secret Monitor (part of the AMD); however it lay dormant from 1929 until its revival in December 2006.

There are six grades, and membership is restricted to Princes of the Order of the Secret Monitor.

The Six Grades:

- Grade I° - Ostiarius or Doorkeeper (Conferred in a Consistory)
- Grade II° - Lector (Conferred in a Consistory)
- Grade III° - Fellow or Healer & Exorcist (Conferred in a Consistory)
- Grade IV° - Councillor (Conferred in a Council of Elders)
- Grade V° - Keeper of the Hidden Secret (Conferred in a Council of the Entrusted)
- Grade VI° - Prince of Jerusalem (Conferred in a Council of Princes)

Membership:

The qualifications for membership are as follows: Candidates for the Ancient and Masonic Order of the Scarlet Cord must be Master Masons and Princes (2nd. Degree) of the Order of the Secret Monitor.

<https://markmasonshall.org/orders/scarlet-cord/215-the-ancient-and-masonic-order-of-the-scarlet-cord>

<http://www.alliedmasonicdegrees.org/scarletcord.htm>

Red Cross of Constantine

Known formally as the Masonic and Military Order of the Red Cross of Constantine and the Orders of the Holy Sepulchre and St. John the Evangelist, this group has three degrees and two appendant orders:

Degrees

- Knight-Mason
- Priest-Mason (or Installed Eusebius)
- Prince Mason

Orders

- The Order of the Holy Sepulchre
- The Order of St. John the Evangelist

The Red Cross of Constantine is officially The Masonic and Military Order of the Red Cross of Constantine and the Orders of the Holy Sepulchre and St. John the Evangelist, the latter two of which are called the Appendant Orders. There are also two chair degrees conferred on the Viceroy and Sovereign of a Conclave, and two honorary orders: Knight Commander of Constantine and Knight Grand Cross. The governing body of the Order for the United States of America and Its Jurisdiction is styled The United Grand Imperial Council of Knights of the Red Cross of Constantine and Appendant Orders for the United States of America and Its Jurisdiction.

The purpose of the Constantinian Orders are to commemorate the first elevation of Christianity from the position of a despised and proscribed heresy to that of a legally recognized and honored religion, to cultivate the social virtues, appeal to the intellectual and moral qualities, preserve as far as possible the customs of the fraternity and bring about good fellowship and understanding between all branches of Masonry.

Knights Companions of the Order meet in Conclaves of the Red Cross of Constantine and a member must be a Royal Arch Mason in good standing and subscribe to a belief in the Christian religion as revealed in the New Testament. Membership is by invitation and each Conclave has a prescribed membership limit.

This body is governed at the national level; in the United States, its governing entity is the United Grand Imperial Council.

<https://mwsite.org/sites/rcc/>

<http://www.redcrossconstantine.org/>

Knight Masons

The Order of Knight Masons is open to all Master Masons who are also members of a Royal Arch Chapter. This body meets in three separate councils and has three degrees:

- Knight of the Sword
- Knight of the East
- Knight of the East and West

There is no international governing body; there are Knight Mason Councils in Ireland, the USA, South Africa, Hong Kong, Jamaica, Tasmania, India, Gibraltar, Australia, New Zealand, Bermuda, Greece, England, and Singapore.

<http://knightmasons.org/>

The Masonic Order of Athelstan in England, Wales and its Provinces Overseas The Provincial Grand Court of the United States of America.

The Masonic Order of Athelstan was constituted in the USA on February 8th, 2011 during AMD Week with two Courts established, one in North Carolina and the other in Pennsylvania. The order is relative new in its founding country of England in that it has only been in existence for a little over five years. A slow and deliberate rate of growth has been chosen as the best method to ensure positive results. As you will learn from the attached background information, the Masonic Order of Athelstan instructs its members on many symbols and their meaning that has in some jurisdictions been removed from the Craft Lodge. Where these symbols have been retained you will find that they are presented in a more esoteric manner than they are in the Craft Lodge which leads the serious Masonic student down a totally different path of learning and perception. The Masonic Order of Athelstan not only complements the Craft Lodge experience, it stimulates the mind to various new areas of research while renewing the one's interest in the Craft and Chapter Degrees.

The body is referred to as a "Court". It is an invitation only organization. Having stated this, if you are interested in joining the Order or establishing a Court in your local jurisdiction please contact me and the appropriate information will be provided to start the process.

Those wishing to join an existing Court, will upon request, be sent a membership application form. Once received, it will be sent to the Screening Committee of the appropriate Court for review. The Screening Committee will make a determination if an invitation is warranted. You will be notified of their decision.

The Order of the Scarlet Mantle is appendant to the Masonic Order of Athelstan and has its own Statutes. It was created from the outset as the separate reward-based Order for meritorious service by members within the Order of Athelstan.

Knights are installed or promoted in a ceremony commemorative of the Knighting of Athelstan by King Alfred the Great in and around the year 898 (the first recorded making of a Knight in England). It is stated that Athelstan, upon being knighted was given a 'Scarlet Mantle and a Sword with a golden hilt and a scarlet mantle bedecked with jewels'. Members bear the initials of Knight of the Scarlet Mantle (KSM), Knight Commander of the Scarlet Mantle (KCSM) or Grand Cross of the Scarlet Mantle (GCSM) after their name and naturally can only use this in the context of the Masonic Order of Athelstan.

The Order is administered by a Grand High Chancellor following his appointment by the Most Worshipful Grand Master. A small number of Grand Chancellors are also appointed to assist the Grand High Chancellor. Knightings normally take place on the day of, and preceding, the Annual Assembly of the Masonic Order of Athelstan in October/November.

<https://www.athelstanusa.org/>

The Worshipful Society of Free Masons, Rough Masons, Wallers, Slaters, Paviers, Plaisterers and Bricklayers - (The Operatives)

The Worshipful Society of Free Masons, Rough Masons, Wallers, Slaters, Paviers, Plaisterers and Bricklayers - (The Operatives) is an invitational body dedicated to the preservation of the history and workings of operative guild masonry.

The Society was founded in 1913 as the Channel Row Assemblage. The ritual and working is more archaic than that of Craft Masonry, containing practical instruction of which only echoes are found in speculative ritual. There are 7 Degrees:

- I° Indentured Apprentice
- II° Fellow of the Craft
- III° Super-Fellow, Fitter & Marker
- IV° Super-Fellow, Setter Erector
- V° Intendent, Overseer, Super Intendent & Warden
- VI° Passed Master;
- VII° Master Mason of whom three are Grand Master Masons.

Bodies are termed Assemblages, consisting of one Lodge of each Degree, from I° to IV°, ruled by a Deputy Master Mason. Lodges of the V° and VI° function under the Grand Assemblage, controlled by an authorized Deputy Grand Master Mason. The VII° is under direct control of the Grand Assemblage.

A candidate for the Society must be a Master Mason, a Mark Master Mason and a Royal Arch Companion in good standing. Once accepted, a candidate can progress to the V° without additional qualification, but must be an Installed Master in both Craft and Mark before he can be promoted to the VI°.

<http://www.operatives-usa.org/>

The Commemorative Order of St. Thomas of Acon

The Commemorative Order of St. Thomas of Acon is an invitational chivalric and Masonic order. In the United States of America, the Order is governed by the Grand Master's Council, which warrants local Chapels of the Order. Chapels may be grouped into larger administrative units, known as Provinces, as needs require. The Grand Master's Council meets annually, generally in conjunction with the Grand Council of the Allied Masonic Degrees for the United States of America.

A candidate for admission must be a subscribing Master Mason in a Craft Lodge in amity with the United Grand Lodge of England, a subscribing Royal Arch Mason in a Royal Arch Chapter, or its equivalent in other countries, in amity with the Supreme Grand Chapter of England and a subscribing

Knight Templar, or its equivalent in other countries, in amity with the United Religious, Military and Masonic Orders of the Temple and of St. John of Jerusalem, Palestine, Rhodes and Malta.

<http://www.stthomasacon.org/>

The York Rite Sovereign College of North America

The purposes of this invitational body are:

- To foster a spirit of cooperation [and] coordination among each of the Bodies of York Rite Masonry.
- To assist in worthy efforts to improve the ritualistic and dramatic presentation of York Rite work.
- To conduct an education program in order to inculcate a greater appreciation of the principles, ideals and programs of York Rite Masonry.
- To strengthen York Rite Masonry in every possible manner.
- To build up a love of country and to aid and support genuine Americanism.
- To reward outstanding service to York Rite Masonry by awards, [honors,] and other methods of proper recognition.
- To support Charitable and Benevolent Endeavors of Freemasonry (source).

Membership in a College is by invitation, and is restricted to those who hold membership in all of the other York Rite bodies. Since the primary object of every College is to foster a spirit of service and to promote and support the York Rite in every way possible, it is no surprise to find many of the leaders of the Craft numbered among its ranks. Here they find a common ground from which they can act for the welfare of all York Rite bodies without special favor to any. Colleges have been active in the organization of York Rite Festivals, degree teams, drill corps, and many other functions which serve to assist, coordinate, and unify the Rite.

It is governed by the York Rite Sovereign College of North America.

The pre-requisite for membership by invitation is to be in good standing with your Masonic lodge, Royal Arch Chapter, Cryptic council, and Knight Templar Commandery (or Preceptory, if you live in Canada).

Order of the Purple Cross

This is an honor presented to those members of the York Rite College who have “distinguished themselves by their service to humanity or to the Rite.”

<https://www.yrscna.org/>

Holy Royal Arch Knight Templar Priests

This is an honorary body for those who have given an “outstanding performance as a Commander of a Commandery of Knights Templar.”

It is governed by the Grand College of America Holy Royal Arch Knight Templar Priests.

<http://www.hraktp.org/>

York Rite and/or Scottish Rite

Royal Order of Scotland

This is an international body, headquartered in Edinburgh, Scotland. It presides over its own provincial grand lodges, such as the one in the USA.

Overall, the minimum requirements needed to be invited to join are:

- Membership in Craft Masonry
- At least five years as a Master Mason
- A profession of the Trinitarian Christian faith

Various jurisdictions add requirements to this. In the United States, one must also be a Knight Templar through the York Rite or a 32° member of the Scottish Rite.

Evidence must also be provided that the invitee has served the Craft, the Church, or the public.

<https://roosusa.org/>

The Society of Blue Friars (Masonic Authors)

by Wallace McLeod

“The Society of Blue Friars” was formed in 1932, explicitly “to recognize Masonic Authors.” It is probably the smallest, and certainly one of the oddest, concordant bodies in Masonry. It has no fixed ritual or ceremonies, no dues or fees, and very few records. The name was chosen, presumably, because “Friar” is related to the French word for “Brother,” and is therefore appropriate for a Masonic group; but it would also call to mind the monks of the Middle Ages, the ones who wrote most of the books in those days. The regulations (at least in their present form) state that “One new Friar shall be appointed each year,” but that “additional Friars may be appointed to fill vacancies caused by demise or resignation when the total membership is not over twenty.”

Since 1944 the Society has met once a year (except for 1945), in a session that is open to all Masonic Brethren. The “Consistory” takes place in Washington, D.C., in February, as part of the annual Masonic weekend that is sponsored by the Allied Masonic Degrees. At the annual meeting, the new Friar is proclaimed, and is expected to deliver a research paper. In earlier times, the papers were sometimes printed in the Miscellanea of the Allied Masonic Degrees. In recent years they have appeared in The Philalethes magazine. Possibly the collected Blue Friar Lectures may be published at some time in the future

The Society has a short list of regulations. They tell us that there are three officers. The presiding officer is the Grand Abbot, who retains his office as long as he wishes, or as long as he lives. He appoints the Deputy Grand Abbot (who is his designated successor), and the Secretary-General. The Grand Abbot may receive nominations for new Friars, but the final decision as to who shall be selected rests entirely with him. There are neither dues nor fees. And the regulations can be changed only at the pleasure of the Grand Abbott.

<http://www.mwsite.org/sbf/>

Masonic Order of the Bath

Not to be confused with the British chivalric order, the Masonic Order of the Bath was founded on June 21, 1921, in Red Bank, N.J.—the other home of many of these bodies, besides Monroe, N.C.—under the original name of “The Wahoo Band.” As I’m sure one can guess by the original title, it is the first in this synopsis of what are sometimes referred to as the “fun” degrees; in which the social and charitable aspects of Masonry reign supreme. It took the name Masonic Order of the Bath on May 5, 1930.

Royal Society of Knights Occidental

The Knights Occidental are one of the newer groups at Masonic Week and should perhaps be referred to as a “Dinner Degree” without any ceremony. First established at the Hotel Washington during Masonic Week in 1997 by Bros. Milton Dirst, Gary Hermann, and William Koon, The Royal Society of Knights Occidental has met for the purposes of food and fellowship every year since. Membership is open to all, and the dues are merely the price of dinner.

The Most Noble Sovereign Order of Knights Commander

The Most Noble Sovereign Order of Knights Commander is an Honor Group for those who are dedicated in the Masonic Fraternity as a Labor of Love. Those who labor will be rewarded by being invited.

REQUIREMENTS:

Below is a list of requirements to join The Most Noble Sovereign Order of Knights Commander, at the bottom of the page is our application form Entitled Form A:

Must belong to two (2) of the following “High Degree Systems” (Multiple Rites could be used as a bonus):

- York Rite
- Scottish Rite
- Adonhiramite Rite
- Modern Rite
- Swedish Rite
- Brazilian Rite
- Baldwin Rite
- Other _____

Must belong to one (1) social group (check all that apply)

- Shrine
- Grotto
- Tall Cedars of Lebanon
- High Twelve International
- Royal Society of Knights Occidental
- Order of the Bath
- Order of the Cork
- Sciots
- National Sojourners
- Order of the Sword of Bunker Hill

Must belong to at least five (5) Invitational bodies of the following (check all that apply)

- Knight Masons
- Allied Masonic Degrees (AMD)
- York Rite College (YRC)
- Knight York Cross of Honor (KYCH)
- Red Cross of Constantine (RCC)

- Holy Royal Arch Knight Templar Pries (KTP)
- Royal Order of Scotland (ROOS)
- Societas Rosicruciana (SRICF) (SRIA) (SRIS) (SRIL)
- NOT RECCOMENDED - ~~Royal Order of Jesters (ROJ)~~
- NOT RECCOMENDED - ~~Order of Quetzalcoatl (Q)~~
- St. Thomas of Acon
- The Operatives
- Masonic Order of Athelstan
- Universal Craftsmen Council of Engineers
- Order of Knights Preceptors
- Knight Crusaders of the Cross (or comparable Past Commanders degree)
- Order of High Priesthood (or comparable Past High Priest degree)
- Order of the Silver Trowel (or comparable Past T.I.M. degree)
- CBCS / RER / KBHC
- NOT RECCOMENDED - ~~SOBIB~~

Must have presided over at least two (2) invitational bodies

- 1.) - _____
- 2.) - _____

Must belong to at least one (1) research society/ group from the following (check all that apply)

- Grand College of Rites
- Scottish Rite Research Society
- Society of Blue Friars
- Research Lodge – (Name) _____
- Philalethes Society
- Masonic Society
- Other _____

Bonus: Belong to an auxiliary family group (check all that apply)

- Order of the Eastern Star
- Order of DeMolay
- White Shrine of Jerusalem
- Order of Amaranth
- Rainbow Adviser
- Job's Daughters Adviser
- Order of DeMolay Board
- Other _____

Bonus – Awards & Honors: Honors Received in Masonic Bodies. At the discretion of the Executive High Council, these honors may substitute other requirements. (check all that apply)

- 32° KCCH
- 33°
- VIII°/ IX° – SRICF
- Order of the Purple Cross
- Order of Scarlet Mantle
- Order of Knights Eagles and Tigers (OKET)
- Red Branch of Eri
- Knight Commander of Zerubbabel
- Order of Scarlet Cord
- Other _____

Special Honors:

Knight – Eligible for Knighthood if you attend 5 annual meetings

Grand Cross – Eligible for Grand Cross if: (verification & fee required)

- Belong to 15 invitational bodies
- Presided over at least 4 Invitational bodies
- Belong to 6 social groups & preside over at least 1.
- Belong to at least 2 research groups.
- Belong to at least 1 auxiliary groups.

Special Award – Eligible for special award if you belong to 19 of 20 invitational bodies (verification & fee required)

Knight Grand Cross – Eligible for Knight Grand Cross for being a past presiding officer of a Grand body (verification & fee required)

Knight Supreme Grand Cross – Eligible for Supreme Grand Cross if you belong to everything on Form A. (verification & fee required)

The Supreme Grand Master reserves the right to make members at sight or waive requirements

After a Mason has fulfilled the requirements of membership, his name may be proposed for membership and approved by the Supreme High Council. The prospective member should not know he is being proposed until the Supreme High Council or the Executive High Council has approved the proposal.

<https://sovereignorderofknightscommander.wordpress.com/about/>

The Grand Council of the Universal Craftsmen's Council of Engineers

The purpose for the Universal Craftsmen's Council of Engineers is for the better education, improvement and elevation of engineers both in and out of the Masonic Fraternity. Must be a Master Mason in Good Standing.

<https://sites.google.com/site/uccegc/home>

<https://www.facebook.com/UniversalCraftsmenCouncilOfEngineersInc/>

CBCS

Chevaliers Bienfaisants de la Cité Sainte, or Knights Beneficent of the Holy City.

Chevaliers Bienfaisants de la Cité Sainte, or Knights Beneficent of the Holy City. Outside of the U.S., CBCS is a system of the Rite Ecossais Rectifié (Scottish Rectified Rite), and considered to be the oldest continuously operating Christian chivalric Masonic Order in the world, tracing its roots back to Baron Karl Gotthelf von Hund's "Rite of Strict Observance" in Germany in the 1750s. By widespread agreement, even though it possesses its own degree rituals for the Entered Apprentice, Fellow Craft and Master Mason degrees, like the Scottish Rite systems in the U.S. and most of Europe, it acknowledges that those degrees are the sole domain of Masonic grand lodges.

The Chevaliers Bienfaisants de la Cité Sainte is the oldest order with a continuous existence connected with Freemasonry. It was originally founded as the Rite of Strict Observance by Karl Gotthelf, Baron von Hund, in 1751. It continued to flourish and attract outstanding political and royal members until his death in 1776. It emphasized a Templar origin of Freemasonry, and an "Unknown Superior" known as the "Knight of the Red Feather," (alleged to be the Stuart Pretender, Prince Charles Edward). The system became so associated with intrigue and politics that reforms were indicated. ["Whatever Similarities there may be between the KT and CBCS they are nonetheless separate Orders with very different rituals and procedures," as stated at Item No. 9 styled "Order of Precedence" in the "Agenda" document published by the 8th Knight Templar Triennial International Conference held in Winchester, England on September 4, 2009.]

As explained by Jean-Claude Tardivat in 1994, then Grand Chancellor of the Great Priory of France (des Gaules):

"The Scottish Rectified Regime is a Masonic and Chivalrous Christian System established In France in the fourth quarter of the 18th century.

* * *

"The Scottish Rectified Regime has three formal origins and two spiritual sources of inspiration.

"The three origins are:

—The French Free Masonry (structured later on, in 1786-1787, in a System named 'French Rite'.)

—'l'Ordre des Chevaliers Maçons Elus Coens de l'Univers,' specific system of Martinez de Pasqually.

And —The Strict Observance, which is a German system more chivalrous than Masonic" — excuse me for my pronunciation — "willing to be the restorer of the Order of the Temple abolished in 1312.

"The two spiritual sources are:

—The esoteric doctrine of Martinez de Pasqually about the origin, the condition, and the future of Man and Universe.

And —The Christian Tradition.

"All this was officially approved, first nationally by the Convent of Lyon in 1778 (and the ratification of the Codes of the Rectified Lodges and of the CBCS, Chevaliers Bienfaisants de la Cité Sainte, Beneficent Knights of the Holy City, still ruling the Regime), then internationally by the Convent of Wilhelmsbad in 1782 (and the rally of the main leaders of German Strict Observance).

"Originally, the Scottish Rectified Regime had three classes:

—The Symbolic class, or Masonic Order, subdivided in four degrees:

—Three Degrees of the Craft worked in the Lodges of St. John, called Blue Lodges, due to the colour of their regalia.

* * *

-The fourth degree is worked in the Lodges of St. Andrew, called Green Lodges, for the same reasons—that being for the color of the regalia.

* * *

"These four degrees are centered on the inner reconstruction of the man through a deeper appreciation of his faith and the diligent practice (observance) of the Christian virtues.

"When the Master of St. Andrew has reached the level of self-spiritual realization, proving that he has worked up the Masonic initiation, he can access to the Inner Order.

"This Inner Order, which is a Knightly Order has two stages:

- The first one, preparatory, transitory, but revocable, is the stage of Novice Squire.
- The second one, which not a degree but a quality conferred by dubbing, is Chevallier Bienfaisant de a Cité Sainte, which is Knight Benevolent of the Holy City, or CBCS."

These were accomplished at the Convent des Gaules held at Lyons, France in 1778 with further clarification when convened at Wilhelmsbad, Germany, in 1782. Early concepts of origin were repudiated and a new order emerged, "Knights Beneficent of the Holy City." [Arthur Edward Waite in his work entitled "The Secret Tradition in Masonry," which was printed in 1911 and 1937, stated that the CBCS was "divested of the Templar claim" Waite concludes that "the convention of Lyons (1778) divested the Rite of Strict Observance of its Templar elements which were of a spiritual and moral kind." According to Jean-Francois Bar, the Freemason Jean-Baptiste Willermoz blended together the "form" and the "doctrine," and stripped the Templar clothing from the Rite of Strict Observance. In other words he de-templarised the Rite of Strict Observance and "Martinized" it, and the result was the Rectified Scottish Rite.]

As a result of the general political unrest in Europe consequent to the French Revolution and church mandates, the order was transferred to Geneva under the title of the Grand Prieure d'Helvétie, Regime Rectifie Ecossais (Great Priory of Helvetia, Rectified Scottish Regime).

At the present time, there are nine Great Priories in North America, Europe, Africa and South America, including Switzerland (erected 2/17/1779), United States of America (8/27/1934), France (3/23/1935, reconstituted 5/8/2000), England (2/6/1937), Belgium (constituted 1986), Portugal (instituted 5/26/95) Togo (Warrant received from France 7/12/99 and charter received from Switzerland 5/21/2011), Brazil (2008), Spain (2009), and Italy (2010 or 2011). It appears that there is a Lodge of St. Andrew in Bucharest, Romania. All charters have been received from Switzerland other than as noted. Canada was granted a charter by the Martinist Order in Paris in approximately 1985.

[While visiting the Annual Convocation of the Grand Prieuré Indépendant d'Helvétie in Geneva, Switzerland, on 19-20 March, 2005, a document entitled Letters Patent was viewed on the wall of the Masonic building by Reverend Knights Reese L. Harrison, Jr. and Andre Ernest Lovas of The Great Priory of America. This document states that "on the fraternal request addressed to us {Switzerland}, given, and in fact do give, to the Great Priory of England and Wales {Knights Templar} the PRESENT LETTERS PATENT to invest it with the exclusive Right and Power to govern, administer and exercise within the territory of its Jurisdiction, all matters concerning the said Order Interiour. These Letters Patent bear witness to all whom it may concern that the two above-mentioned Sovereign Bodies hereby agree that the Great Priory of England and Wales {Knights Templar} is and shall be acknowledged by all concerned as the Body Sovereign within its Jurisdiction in all matters concerning the said Order Interiour, standing possessed of all such prerogatives, power, rights, and privileges, as are customarily possessed by Sovereign Bodies, it being mutually understood that the landmarks and principles of said Order Interiour shall be maintained inviolate. So Resolved and Given February 6, 1937".]

[On October 2, 2007, a duplicate original of the aforementioned document was viewed by Most Reverend Reese L. Harrison, Jr. in the office of the Grand Secretary of the Grand Lodge of Mark Master Masons of England and Wales, who also is the Secretariat of the other Masonic Orders administered at Mark Masons Hall in London, England, including the Great Priory of Anglia, C.B.C.S.]

[Prior to the 1937 Patent from Switzerland to England, on February 28, 1903, Arthur Edward Waite was admitted to C.B.C.S. in Switzerland and it is alleged that he was given the sole authority for disseminating C.B.C.S. in England, but the Great Priory of Switzerland did not see him in that light and agreed to grant a charter for C.B.C.S. in England to the Great Priory of Templary of England and Wales. Arthur Edward Waite apparently received a charter from the Great Priory of Switzerland on April 16, 1903. In 1929, Waite admitted in written correspondence that he did not found the Order in England, and that his sole activity had been to recommend B. H. Springett in 1924, and G. E. W. Bridge in 1929, to the authorities in Geneva, Switzerland. Additionally, his only dissemination of the Order in England was through Waite's literary references to the order. Thus, previous writings that a Great Priory of Anglia was founded by Waite are in error. Waite's charter and/or authority from the Great Priory in Switzerland was never executed. See R. A. Gilbert, "The Masonic Career of A. E. Waite, Volume 99, *Ars Quatuor Coronatorum* (1986), pages 6-20, with minor typographical errors corrected 2002/04/06 and on the website at <http://Freemasonry.bcy.ca/aqc/waite/waite.html> at pages 14-16.] [In 1987, after publishing an article entitled "The Masonic Career of A. E. Waite," in Volume 99 of *Ars Quatuor Coronatorum* for the year 1986, pp. 6-20, Masonic researcher and Waite biographer, Robert A. Gilbert, wrote a book entitled *A. E. Waite: Magician of Many Points*. Gilbert wrote that he did not expect to have conclusions based on what seemed to be incontrovertible facts, drawn from the documentary evidence then available, rudely overthrown. But so it is: manuscripts that have come to light since then have shown that when I wrote that Waite "made no attempt to disseminate the Rectified rite and never worked the grades which had been conferred upon him" (p. 130), I was wrong.

The last three words above, and the above-quoted material, appear in Gilbert's work entitled "A. E. Waite and the Rectified Rite in England," received by this Great Priory of America on March 6, 2007, and otherwise undated, but apparently written subsequent to 1986 and 1987. Gilbert's 1986 and 1987 publications regarding C.B.C.S. are consistent with one another. His publication received in 2007 is inconsistent with his prior publications of 1986 and 1987. Gilbert states that

"A potentially embarrassing situation was resolved within a few months by the establishment of a Concordat between the Great Priory of England and Wales and those working the Rectified Rite under Waite's Charter. This ensured mutual recognition of the legitimacy of the respective Patent and Charter, and limited each body to a maximum of nine members. It was also agreed that the 'Waite' Commandery, C.B.C.S., would not conduct its affairs 'in any manner different from that in which they have been conducted heretofore' unless by mutual agreement."

On September 29, 2007, and again on October 2, 2007, officials of the Great Priory of Anglia operating pursuant to the 1937 Patent did not express acknowledgement or awareness of a Concordat between the 1903 Waite Charter and the 1937 Patent to the Great Chancellor of the Great Priory of America.

In the September 2007 issue of The Square magazine published in England an article by Richard Collins appears regarding the history and working of British C.B.C.S. pursuant to the 1937 Patent and the controlled expansion of the Rectified Scottish Rite in England under the Grand Mastership of Leslie Felgate Dring, and the Consecration on May 1, 2007, of St. James Lodge of St. Andrew No. 2

It is to be noted that the Martinist Order and the Swedish Rite also include some of the C.B.C.S. degrees.

In Switzerland, Knights receiving the C.B.C.S. degrees and 33rd Degree members of the Supreme Council of the Scottish Rite of Freemasonry are accorded similar honors and privileges.

The Great Priory of America was established in 1934 by authority of the Grand Prieure Independant d'Helvétie when Letters Patent for the Rite were delivered to William Moseley Brown and John Raymond Shute, II. These Knights were invested with the Supreme Degree of the rite on August 27, 1934 at Geneva, Switzerland, which represents also the date of our charter.

The first meeting in the United States was held at Alexandria, Virginia, February 23, 1935, with fourteen Founder Members:

- J. Edward Allen - Warrenton, North Carolina
- Luther T. Hartsell, Jr. - Concord, North Carolina
- Fred F. Bahnson - Winston-Salem, North Carolina
- Charles C. Hunt - Cedar Rapids, Iowa
- William Moseley Brown - Clarendon, Virginia
- Joseph M. Lowndes - Casper, Wyoming
- Charles C. Cameron - Springfield, Massachusetts
- John Raymond Shute, II - Monroe, North Carolina
- James M. Clift - Richmond, Virginia
- Charles A. Snodgrass - Chattanooga, Tennessee
- Chester G. Cole - Des Moines, Iowa
- Otto R. Souders - Wichita, Kansas
- C. Vernon Eddy - Winchester, Virginia
- Clarence J. West - Washington, D.C.

Great Priory controls six degrees, and the organization for their management. These are:

A. Lodges of the Strict Observance

1. Entered Apprentice
2. Fellowcraft
3. Master Mason

B. Lodge of St. Andrew

1. Scottish Master
2. Perfect Scottish Master

C. Order of the Interior

1. Squire-Novice
2. Knight Beneficient of the Holy City of Jerusalem

Anciently, the Rite of Strict Observance conferred the craft degrees which right has never been surrendered. However, the present organization recognizes symbolic Grand Lodges as the sole authority for establishing and governing lodges of Symbolic Freemasonry.

Membership in the Great Priory of America is by invitation and is limited to Master Masons who profess a belief in the Christian religion.

Contrary to what has been published in the past, the Charter of the Great Priory of America does not provide for the establishment of only three prefectures.

Membership in each Prefecture is limited to eighty one with the possibility of a full complement of two-hundred and forty-three. This figure has never been reached.

Great Priory is vested in the Directorate composed of the Great Prior, Deputy Great Prior, Great Treasurer, Great Chancellor, and the three Prefects. Each officer is elected at the annual meeting held in February at Washington, D.C.

To him who holds the C.B.C.S. there is nothing beyond the ne plus ultra of the craft. It is the summit of Christian Knighthood and is the only comparable Order in this country approaching civil knighthood in Europe. It is guarded carefully and only conferred infrequently upon those who are deemed worthy.

<https://greatprioryofamerica.ipower.com/>

The Grand Order of the Sword of Bunker Hill

The Grand Order of the Sword of Bunker Hill is a Historical and Patriotic Order; founded to perpetuate the principles of American liberty, and to indelibly impress upon the minds of each generation the sacrifices made by our Masonic forefathers in forming and establishing the United States of America.

If you are a Master Mason in good standing you are eligible for membership into this Order. We have something worthwhile for every Master Mason, the spirit of fraternal patriotism celebrating

American liberty, which is extended to you welcoming you to become a member of our Order and enjoy its social and fraternal activities.

There are no annual dues, ever. A Sword membership card is good for a lifetime so long as good standing in the Lodge is maintained.

<http://www.swordofbunkerhill.org/join.html>

Research Societies:

Quatuor Coronati Lodge No. 2076

The Aims of the Lodge

QC's aims have remained broadly the same for over a century: to maintain an interest in Masonic research by presenting and discussing original research papers; publishing papers and comments in AQC; and supporting and encouraging Masonic scholars globally.

The Objects of the Lodge were set out in the first volume of AQC:

- Provide a centre and bond of union for students of Freemasonry and Masonic history
- Attract Freemasons to meetings of QC in order to encourage an appreciation of Masonic research
- Submit the discoveries or conclusions of researchers to the judgment and criticism of their peers by means of papers read in Lodge
- Submit these communications and the discussions arising to the general body of the Craft by publishing the Transactions of the Lodge
- Reprint scarce and valuable works on Freemasonry
- Allow the English-speaking Craft to become acquainted with the progress of Masonic study elsewhere by translations (in whole or part) of non-English language works
- Tabulate concisely in the Transactions the progress of the Craft throughout the world
- Acquire permanent premises and form a Masonic library and museum

Each of these aims remain valid except the last. Quatuor Coronati found a permanent home in Freemasons' Hall, Great Queen Street, London, and the Library & Museum houses our books and archives and stores certain of our possessions. Others have been gifted or placed on loan to Masonic museums elsewhere. Advances in technology have relieved us of the need for a physical office and permanent staff, and QCCC is administered today by a small number of volunteers.

<https://www.quatuorcoronati.com/about-qc-lodge/membership/>

Grand College of Rites

While similar to AMD, in that most outsiders have never heard of the degrees contained therein, the Grand College of Rites is the repository of extinct rituals. However, they do not perform these degrees but merely publish the ritual in their annual volume, *Collectanea*. The Grand College was formed by nine brethren on May 12, 1932, in Washington, D.C., to study Masonic organizations which were not associated with recognized bodies in the U.S., to prevent attempts to resurrect such bodies, and finally to preserve and publish such rituals. Membership is open to all Master Masons in good standing.

<https://grandcollegeofrites.org/membership/petition-to-join/>

The Masonic Society

The Masonic Society is the newest of the Research Societies included in this synopsis. It was founded on May 1, 2008. While often compared to the Philalethes Society, in that they both have quarterly publications, the Masonic Society has no limit on the number of Fellows (Philalethes is limited to forty). It also requires all members to be Master Masons recognized by the Conference of Grand Masters of Masons in North America.

<https://www.themasonicsociety.com/>

Philalethes Society

Formed on October 1, 1928, the Philalethes Society is the oldest research society in this synopsis. Beginning in March 1946, the Society has published their bi-monthly magazine, *The Philalathes*, meaning “lover of truth.” Their roster of forty Fellows has included some of the most important Masonic scholars of the 20th century such as Carl H. Claudy, Robert I. Clegg, Harold V.B. Voorhis, and A.E. Waite.¹² General membership is open to all.

<https://philalethes.myshopify.com/products/new-membership-international>

Scottish Rite Research Society

The Scottish Rite Research Society (SRRS) was founded in 1991 to promote Masonic scholarship and, particularly, research into the Scottish Rite. The SRRS’ annual publication is *Heredom*, after the mythical Scottish mountain which has long been associated with high-degree Masonry. It has roughly 4,000 members and is open to all.

<http://scottishriteresearch.com/membership-join/>

Source:

<http://www.swordofbunkerhill.org/join.html>

<https://freemasonsfordummies.blogspot.com/2010/12/grand-priory-of-scottish-reformed.html>

<https://www.amdusa.org/MasonicWeek/>

<https://scottishrite.org/blog/about/media-publications/journal/article/masonic-week-for-the-uninitiated/>

<https://sovereignorderofknightscommander.wordpress.com/requirements/>

<https://amdusa.org/wp/>

<https://yorkrite.org/wp/>

<https://www.ggcrami.org/>

<https://www.crypticmasons.org/>

<https://knightstemplar.org/wp/>

<https://kych.org/>

<https://scarlet-cord-ea.com/the-six-grades.php>

<https://yrscna.org/>

<https://hraktp.org/>

<https://sricf.org/>

<https://mwsite.org/sites/rcc/>

<http://www.knightmasons.org/>

<http://www.grandcollegeofrites.org/>

<http://www.stthomasacon.org/>

<http://www.athelstanusa.org/>

<http://www.operatives-usa.org/>

<https://mwsite.org/sites/orderofkp/>

<http://www.themasonicsociety.com/>

<http://www.mwsite.org/sbf>

<http://www.amdusa.org/corks/>

<http://www.roosusa.org/>
<http://www.high12.org/>
<https://www.tallcedars.org/>
<https://nationalsojourners.org/>
<https://scgrotto.org/>
<https://philalethes.myshopify.com/>
<https://orderofbeauceant.org/>
<http://www.amaranth.org/>
<http://www.supremeshrine.org/>
<http://www.daughtersofthenile.com/>
<https://easternstar.org/>
<http://www.msana.com/>
<http://www.msana.com/>
<http://www.gorainbow.org/>
<https://beademolay.org/>
<http://scottishrite.org/>
<http://www.scottishritenmj.org/>

APPENDIX B –

A Glossary of Terms defining the levels of membership.

Glossary

There are levels within the Fraternity -

- **Profane** (from the Latin Pro Fanuum - which literally means “one who is without or outside the temple” - we use this term to mean the uninitiated or uninstructed)
- **Aspirant** (one who aspires or desires to join)
- **Petitioner** (One who has submitted a Petition or Application for Membership, or Affiliation)

- **Candidate** (One who is working towards advancement between the Degrees of Freemasonry - often through proving proficiency in a Catechism or summary of ceremonies)
- **Ambassador** (One who has at least been initiated an Entered apprentice and involuntarily receives the Mantle of Character, with it the Yoke of Responsibility and now is the image of Freemasonry representing the entire Masonic Family to the world.)
- **Member in Good Standing** (One who has maintained membership and retains full rights, responsibilities, and privileges of membership - often through participation and being current in their annual dues)
- **Coach** (One who instructs a Candidate regarding the etiquette, decorum, protocols, laws, rules, regulations, culture, history, and proficiency of the Catechism within a Lodge)
- **Mentor** (One who performs the solemn duties of a coach, as well as inspires and guides a Mason throughout his chosen Masonic Journey)
- **Officer** (one who serves and protects the Charter, the will of the Lodge, and the Craft)
- **Past Master** (One who has served, possesses the ability to serve again, and has returned to the quarries to labor again as an equal among the Craft)
- **Unrecognized** (the most accurate way to describe a Mason who is irregular, clandestine, bogus, spurious, illegitimate, fraudulent, or is not now currently in amity with, or Fraternally Recognized within the Grand Jurisdiction from which you reside)
- **Healed** (A Mason who was once unrecognized and has through the powers of and authority granted to the Grand Master of the Grand Jurisdiction from which you reside, become made regular)
- **Rusty Trowel** (A Mason who for one reason or another, been absent from Lodge for a period of time)
- **Suspended** (A Mason who has been issued such sentence as a consequence of his own actions or for non-payment of dues)
- **Expelled** (A Mason who has been issued such sentence as a consequence of his own actions)

- **Restored** (A Mason who has been granted full membership through the reconciliation of the matters prevented him from being a member in good standing within his Lodge)

APPENDIX C –
A list of known educational opportunities.

Symbolic Craft Education Resources

- <https://pagrandlodge.org/masonic-education/>
- <https://www.masonic-lodge-of-education.com/>
- <https://freemason.org/masonic-online-leadership-course/>
- <https://www.whatsamason.org/index.htm>
- <https://masonicfind.com/masonic-courses>
- <http://www.freemasons-freemasonry.com/mecfr.html>
- <https://www.nebraskamasoniceducation.com/programs.html>
- <https://grandlodgeofiowa.org/library-2/a-new-revised-reading-course-in-freemasonry/>

York Rite Education Resources

YORK RITE LEADERSHIP TRAINING COURSE

- <https://yorkriteleadership.org/>

CHAPTER

- <https://www.ggcrami.org/aboutus2>
- <https://www.ggcramiclc.org/>
- <https://ny-royal-arch.org/wp/royal-arch-education/>
- <https://www.royalarchmasons.on.ca/education/>
- <https://www.yorkriteofcalifornia.org/roy.../raeducation.html>
- <http://www.ohioram.org/.../Chapter%20Management%20Manual.pdf>
- <http://ram.iayorkrite.org/education/>

COUNCIL

- <https://www.nycryptic.org/education.htm>
- <https://www.nycryptic.org/OfficersManualChapters.htm>
- <https://robertgdavis.net/shop/york-rite/>

COMMANDERY

- <https://knightstemplar.org/.../KTNewMemberPacketO3Nationa...>
- <https://www.knightstemplar.org/122520course.htm>

COMPANION ADEPT OF THE TEMPLE PROGRAM

- <https://companionadept.wixsite.com/companionadept>
- <https://www.yrscna.org/forms/YorkRiteenrollmentform.pdf>

Scottish Rite Education Resources

- <https://www.mastercraftsmancollege.org/>
- <https://scottishritenmj.org/hauts-grades-academy>